BUSINESS ENGLISH

FOR UPPER-INTER LEARNERS



- Hơn **3000** từ vựng cần thiết chia theo chủ đề, đầy đủ 4 kỹ năng kèm file nghe giọng ANH-MỸ chuẩn.

GEN Wise LANGUAGE HUB

TALK TO US
Phone: 0799 713 094
genwise.languagehub@gmail.com

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1

PREFACE

BOOK INTRODUCTION

2

MAIN TOPICS

UNIT 1 3-TRICKS-TO-SAVE-MONEY
UNIT 2 A-CASHLESS-SOCIETY
UNIT 3 BACK-TO-WORK
UNIT 4 BASIC-INCOME
UNIT 5 COMPETITION
UNIT 6 CORPORATE-CRIME
UNIT 7 CULTURAL-KNOW-HOW
UNIT 8 EMBRACING-EMOTIONS-AT-WORK
UNIT 9 FAILING-UP
UNIT 10 FEEDBACK
UNIT 11 GROUPON-CULTURE
UNIT 12 HIRING-CHOICES
UNIT 13 NEGOTIATING-DEALS
UNIT 14 PROBLEM-SOLVING
UNIT 15 QUERYING-FIGURES
UNIT 16 SCALPING
UNIT 17 SELECTING-A-JOB-CANDIDATE
UNIT 18 SHARING-VIEWPOINTS
UNIT 19 SLEEP-LEADERSHIP
UNIT 20 SMALL-TALK
UNIT 21 STARTUP-SUCCESS
UNIT 22 STRESS-RELIEF
UNIT 23 THE-LENGTHY-HIRING-PROCESS

3



SCAN ME

3 TRICKS TO SAVE MONEY



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-R57D-PFP1

1 Warm up

Look at the following tips for saving money. Which do you think would work for you? Which do you think are bad ideas?

1. Put your credit cards in a bowl of water, put them in the freezer and leave them there. Then if you really want to use them, you will have to spend a lot of time waiting to use them. This may make you think more carefully about how often you use them.

2. Put 20% of your pay every month into a separate account and watch it grow.

3. Cook all of your meals for the week on one day so that you are not tempted to eat out and spend extra money.

4. Write down every item you spend your money on and keep a record so you know where your money is going.

5. Treat yourself to something special once a week as a reward for saving money.

6. Keep a photograph of the thing you want, (for example, a car, a new house, a holiday, university tuition) by your bed and look at it every night before you sleep.

2 Discussing language

In pairs, answer the following questions about meaning. Use the Internet or a dictionary if needed.

1. You go to a business conference. You are not sure if you should wear the badge with your name on it or not. What do you do? How is this an example of an **environmental cue**?
2. How much money would someone need to give you to **have an impact** on your life? Whose life do you have an impact on?
3. How do you imagine **your future self**?
4. What problems in your life do you need **to get a handle on**?
5. What **frequent purchases** do you make that you could do without if needed?
6. If someone told you their business deal suffered "**death by a thousand cuts**", what do you think that means?
7. If your department is $4000 **in the hole**, what does that mean?

Think of the following powers:

- The power to improve your own life.
- The power to improve other people's lives.
- The power to be very productive.
- The power to make decisions.

Which of these powers would you most like to **harness**? Why?

3 Focus on vocabulary

Part A: Underline the correct words to complete the definitions.

1. *willpower*: the ability to control and push **yourself/someone else** to achieve something
2. *pre-commitment:* the **possibility/promise** that you will do something (made in advanced)
3. *vow*: to **formally/casually** promise to take action on something in the future
4. *highlight*: to do something that makes people give **less/more** attention to something
5. *transition*: the process of **adding/changing from** one thing to another
6. *ration*: to set a fixed amount of something that you are **allowed/not allowed** to have
7. *irrational*: **based on/not based on** clear logical thoughts and ideas
8. *budgeting*: the process of **not limiting/limiting** the amount of money you spend

Part B: Now add the words from Part A into the gaps in the following questions.

1. Do you have an _____ fear of anything, such as spiders, or heights, or dogs? What is it?
2. Have you ever had to _____ the amount of food you ate? Why? What was the situation?
3. When it comes to your personal money, are you good at _____ , or do you overspend?
4. Who or what in your life have you made a _____ to? Why is it important to you?
5. Did you find it difficult to make the _____ from being a student, to working? What happened?
6. If someone asked you to _____ your achievements, what would you say?
7. Have you ever needed strong _____ to do something, such as start exercising more, or stop smoking? What was it? What happened?
8. What do you _____ to do in the future? Why is it important to you?

Now in pairs, answer the questions.

4 Understanding ideas

Look at these sentences from the script of the video you will watch. Number them in the correct order to form a logical paragraph.

And environmental cues like this have an impact. ____

And what we found was that people who saw their income on a weekly basis were able to budget better throughout the month. ____

In another group, we showed people their income on a weekly basis. ____

Now, it's important to know that we didn't change how much money people were receiving, we just changed the environment in which they understood their income. ____

We ran a study in which, in one group, we showed people their income on a monthly basis. _1__

Why do you think cues like these mentioned above have an impact?

5 Listening for details

Watch the first part of the video (00:00-03:35). Tick the 4 questions that the speaker asks.

- What percentage would you like to save?
- How do we do it?
- How much money do you need?
- Are you ready?
- What is the best way to save?
- Are you ready for retirement?

6 Listening for understanding

Now watch the video again and decide if the following statements are true or false.

1. Generally, people are saving more and more.
2. The speaker wants to help you by connecting what you want to do with what you actually do.
3. We think of our future self as a perfect version of our present self.
4. You may need to have less today so that your future self has more.
5. At the beginning of a new period of time, your motivation goes down.
6. Making spending more difficult can change your behaviour.
7. Limiting the number of times you do something is a good way to save money.

7 Talking point

In pairs, discuss the following questions.

- How would you summarise the three tips that were given in the video?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

- Which of these tips do you think are the most useful? How can you start using those ideas immediately?
- Can you use these tips in your business life? if so, how? What plan can you make right now?
- What mistakes have you made with money in the past? Either personally or with your business.
- What good financial decisions have you made in the past? What do you think has been a good thing to spend your money on?

Transcripts

5. Listening for details

Wendy Dela Rosa: We all know that saving is important and is something that we should be doing. And yet, overall, we're doing less and less of it. We know what we need to do. The question is: How do we do it? And that's what I'm here to teach you. Your savings behaviour isn't a question of how smart you are or how much willpower you have. The amount we save depends on the environmental cues around us. Let me give you an example. We ran a study in which, in one group, we showed people their income on a monthly basis. In another group, we showed people their income on a weekly basis.

Wendy Dela Rosa: And what we found was that people who saw their income on a weekly basis were able to budget better throughout the month. Now, it's important to know that we didn't change how much money people were receiving, we just changed the environment in which they understood their income. And environmental cues like this have an impact.

Wendy Dela Rosa: So I'm not going to share tricks with you that you already know. I'm not going to tell you how to open up a savings account or how to start saving for your retirement. What I am going to share with you is how to bridge this gap from your intentions to save and your actions. Are you ready?

Wendy Dela Rosa: Here's number one: harness the power of pre-commitment. Fundamentally, we think about ourselves in two different ways: our present self and our future self. In the future, we're perfect. In the future, we're going to save for retirement, we're going to lose weight, we're going to call our parents more. But we oftentimes forget that our future self is exactly the same person as our present self. We know that one of the best times to save is when you get your tax return. So we tried an A/B test. In the first group, we texted people in early February, hopefully before they even filed for their taxes. And we asked them, "If you get a tax refund, what percentage would you like to save?"

Wendy Dela Rosa: Now this is a really hard question. They didn't know if they would receive a tax refund or how much. But we asked the question anyway. In the second group, we asked people right after they received their refund, "What percentage would you like to save?"

Wendy Dela Rosa: Now, here's what happened. In that second condition, when people just received their tax refund, they wanted to save about 17 percent of their tax refund. But in the condition when we asked people before they even filed their taxes, savings rates increased from 17 percent to 27 percent when we asked in February. Why? Because you're committing for your future self, and of course your future self can save 27 percent.

Wendy Dela Rosa: These large changes in savings behaviour came from the fact that we changed the decision-making environment. We want you to be able to harness that same power. So take a moment and think about the ways in which you can sign up your future self for something that you know today will be a little bit hard. Sign up for an app that lets you make savings decisions in advance. The trick is, you have to have that binding contract. Number two: use transition moments to your advantage.

Wendy Dela Rosa: We did an experiment with a website that helps older adults share their housing. We ran two ads on social media, targeted to the same population of 64-year-olds. In one group, we said, "Hey, you're getting older. Are you ready for retirement? House sharing can help." In the second group, we got a little bit more specific and said, "You're 64 turning 65. Are you ready for retirement? House sharing can help." What we're doing in that second group is highlighting that a transition is happening.

Wendy Dela Rosa: All of a sudden, we saw click-through rates, and ultimately sign-up rates, increase when we highlight that. In psychology, we call this the "fresh start effect." Whether it's the start of a new year or even a new season, your motivation to act increases. So right now, put a meeting request on your calendar for the day before your next birthday. Identify the one financial thing you most want to do. And commit yourself to it. The third and final trick: get a handle on small, frequent purchases.

Wendy Dela Rosa: We've run a few different studies and found that the number one purchase people say they regret, after bank fees, is eating out. It's a frequent purchase we make almost every day, and it's death by a thousand cuts. A coffee here, a burrito there ... It adds up and decreases our ability to save. Back when I lived in New York City, I looked at my expenses and saw that I spent over 2,000 dollars on ride-sharing apps. It was more than my New York City rent.

Wendy Dela Rosa: I vowed to make a change. And the next month, I spent 2,000 dollars again - no change, because the information alone didn't change my behaviour. I didn't change my environment. So now that I was 4,000 dollars in the hole, I did two things. The first is that I unlinked my credit card from my car-sharing apps. Instead, I linked a debit card that only had 300 dollars a month.

Wendy Dela Rosa: If I needed more, I had to go through the whole process of adding a new card, and we know that every click, every barrier, changes our behaviour. We aren't machines. We don't carry around an abacus every day, adding up what we're spending, in comparison to what we wanted. But what our brains are very good at is counting up the number of times we've done something.

Wendy Dela Rosa: So I gave myself a limit. I can only use ride-sharing apps three times a week. It forced me to ration my travels. I got a handle on my car-sharing expenses to the benefit of my husband, because of the environmental changes that I did. So get a handle on whatever that purchase is for you, and change your environment to make it harder to do so.

Wendy Dela Rosa: Those are my tips for you. But I want you to remember one thing. As human beings, we can be irrational when it comes to saving and spending and budgeting. But luckily, we know this about ourselves, and we can predict how we'll act under certain environments. Let's do that with saving. Let's change our environment to help our future selves.

Key

1. Warm up

10 mins.

Ask the class if anyone thinks they are good at saving money. Then ask them if they think they can be better at saving money. Also ask if anyone is in charge of budgeting for their department or themselves with company money.

Then ask the students to discuss the following tips in pairs or small groups and decide which ones would work for them, and which ones wouldn't. Try to get a consensus from the class for each tip.

2. Discussing language

5 mins.

This exercise takes idiomatic/metaphorical phrases from the video and allows students to discuss their meaning ahead of time. Ask students to discuss the questions. Lower-level students may want to use the Internet to aid their understanding, but see if students can predict the meaning first.

1. An environmental cue is information that you get on what to do or how to act from your environment, not necessarily from what you know. So if everyone is wearing a name badge (the environmental cue), many people will also wear one.
2. Having an impact on something means having the ability to change it, usually, though not necessarily, for the better.
3. Your future self is how we think of ourselves in the future. In the talk, the speaker mentions that most people imagine their future selves as being perfect and improved versions of their current selves.
4. To get a handle on something means to begin to understand something, or to begin to control something.
5. Frequent purchases are anything that is bought regularly and can include snacks, alcohol, take away meals, food and necessities.
6. Death by a thousand cuts is a metaphor meaning that many things go wrong and eventually result in some form of failure.
7. If you are a certain amount in the hole, you are in debt by that amount. This is an informal expression.

Powers:

1. To harness a power is to control a power, much like harnessing a horse. We often use this verb with "power" to give the idea of being in complete control.

3. Focus on vocabulary

5 mins.

Ask students to complete the definitions. They may want to use a dictionary or the Internet to aid in their understanding. Ensure students are aware of pronunciation. You may want to ask them to count the syllables in the words and decide on which syllable is stressed as a small extension activity.

Part A:

1. yourself	2. promise	3. formally	4. more
5. changing from	6. allowed	7. not based on	8. limiting

Part B:

10 mins.

Ask the students to identify the part of speech that would fit the gaps in the questions, and then complete them using the vocabulary from Part A. When that is complete, ask them to discuss the questions in pairs or small groups. Circulate and help as needed.

1. irrational
2. ration
3. budgeting
4. pre-commitment/vow
5. transition
6. highlight
7. willpower
8. vow

4. Understanding ideas

5 mins.

This activity gives the students a chance to see part of the script and help them understand the concept of environmental cues which she mentions and was also covered in the second exercise. Ensure students understand that when people thought about their budget on a weekly basis rather than a monthly basis, their behaviour changed. This was the change in environmental cue that she mentions.

1. We ran a study in which, in one group, we showed people their income on a monthly basis.
2. In another group, we showed people their income on a weekly basis.
3. And what we found was that people who saw their income on a weekly basis were able to budget better throughout the month.
4. Now, it's important to know that we didn't change how much money people were receiving, we just changed the environment in which they understood their income.
5. And environmental cues like this have an impact.

5. Listening for details

5 mins.

This activity allows for students to watch the video while just listening out for very specific questions. If your class is more advanced, you may want to incorporate this task with the Listening for understanding task.

Not used:

-How much money do you need?

-What is the best way to save?

6. Listening for understanding

10 mins.

Ask students to listen for a second time and complete the True/False questions. You may want to ask students to make notes so that they can pinpoint why the answers are true or false.

Note to non-American teachers: The speaker mentions filing taxes which is something everyone does in the US before April 15th. The result of this filing for many Americans is that they get a refund on the taxes which they have paid. This is often received in the Spring. So, when the speaker talks about the tax refund, this is what she is referring to.

1. False."Overall, we're doing less and less of it."
2. True. "What I am going to share with you is how to bridge this gap from your intentions to save and your actions."
3. True. "In the future, we're perfect. In the future, we're going to save for retirement, we're going to lose weight, we're going to call our parents more. But we oftentimes forget that our future self is exactly the same person as our present self."

4. True. "So take a moment and think about the ways in which you can sign up your future self for something that you know today will be a little bit hard."
5. False. "Whether it's the start of a new year or even a new season, your motivation to act increases."
6. True. "If I needed more, I had to go through the whole process of adding a new card, and we know that every click, every barrier, changes our behaviour."
7. True. "What our brains are very good at is counting up the number of times we've done something. So I gave myself a limit. I can only use ride-sharing apps three times a week. It forced me to ration my travels."

7. Talking point

10 mins.

Ask students to discuss the questions. Note that many people will feel uncomfortable talking about personal finance, so ensure information is offered, not asked for and that there is a supportive atmosphere in class. As the teacher, you will be best placed to decide if you want to focus on the money-saving aspects of the students' professional lives, or if you want to keep the conversation more focused on personal finance decisions. Either is possible.

The three tips were:

1. Harness the power of pre-commitment. Make a financial commitment to your future self.
2. Use transition moments to your advantage. Make commitments before a time period begins.
3. Reduce small frequent purchases.

Allow students any sentences which express these ideas clearly.

A CASHLESS SOCIETY



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-S578-AS7Z

1 Warm-up

How do you normally pay for things? In cash or by credit/debit card?

2 Key words

Complete the definitions below:

anonymously	capital flow	cushion	intercept
snoop	traces	vulnerable	

1. If there is a _____ between you and something else, you are protected from possible problems.
2. If you are _____ , you are easy to hurt or attack.
3. If you _____ something, you stop it before it is able to reach its destination.
4. If you do something _____ , you do it without giving your name.
5. _____ is the movement of money for investment in and out of countries.
6. If you do something without leaving any _____ , there is no physical proof that you did it.
7. If you _____ , you look around a place secretly in order to find out information about someone.

3 Find the information

You are going to read an article about a cashless society. Tick the five benefits and drawbacks of using cash that you think will be mentioned. Read the text to check your answers.

- Cash makes it easier to avoid paying taxes. ☐
- People who pay in cash are less vulnerable to cyber theft and government snooping. ☐
- Cash creates opportunities for criminals. ☐
- Cash is more dangerous to carry. ☐
- You can make cash payments anonymously. ☐
- It's harder for the government to control citizens who use cash. ☐
- Cash is easier to lose. ☐



THE INDEPENDENT

The death of cash could give governments more control, experts fear

Countries like Korea and Sweden are looking at making the move towards a cashless society. But money experts fear that the complete disappearance of hard cash would not benefit ordinary people.

1. The move to a completely cashless society could mean governments have ever more control over our wallets.
2. That's the view of Megan McArdle, a columnist at Bloomberg, who said that cash provides a cushion between ordinary people and governments.
3. "Unmonitored resources like cash create opportunities for criminals. But they also create a sort of cushion between ordinary people and a government with extraordinary powers. Removing that cushion leaves people who aren't criminals vulnerable to intrusion into every remote corner of their lives," she wrote on Bloomberg View.
4. Countries like Korea and Sweden are looking at making the move towards a cashless society. But money experts fear that the complete disappearance of hard cash would not benefit ordinary people.
5. In a cashless society, the government might intercept any transaction in which someone tried to lend money to someone accused of a crime, Ms McArdle said.
6. "We probably won't notice how much this power grows every time we swipe a card instead of paying cash. The danger is that by the time we do notice, it will be too late," she said.
7. "If hard cash were to disappear we would need to think about limiting the ability of the government to use the payments system as an instrument to control the behaviour of its citizens," she added.
8. A global economy running without physical cash will make it much easier for governments to control capital flow, according to a report by Startfor, a private intelligence agency.
9. Cash also allows payments to be made anonymously. "You can spend your dollar bills without leaving any traces behind. On the other hand, in a society where all financial transactions are recorded, all of your payment and credit history becomes an easy target for cyber-theft and improper snooping by government agencies," said Dr Patrick Carvalho, a researcher in the Economics Program at the Centre for Independent Studies, Australia.
10. But getting rid of banknotes also has its advantages. Peter Sands, a former chief executive of Standard Chartered, said that getting rid of €500, $100, SFr1,000 and £50 notes would make it harder for tax dodgers to pay people in cash, last month.
11. His statement came after Mario Draghi, the president of the European Central Bank, said last week that €500 notes were under review because of similar concerns that they are used by criminals.
12. While the Bank of Korea is planning for a cashless society by 2020 and Sweden is also making the shift, British citizens are still attached to hard cash.
13. Cash withdrawals amounted to a record £128 billion - made during over two billion visits according to recent figures by UK's Link network of 70,000 ATMs in 2015.
14. The total number of cash withdrawals only grew slightly in 2015 but the value of those withdrawals increased by 2 per cent.
15. "These figures show that cash remains a very important part of our lives here in the UK and is still the most attractive payment option in lots of situations. With the amount of money being withdrawn continuing to increase, it is clear that cash has an important place in our wallets and purses for the foreseeable future," John Howells, Link CEO, said.

The Independent, Thursday 17 March 2016, by Zlata Rodionova

4 Checking understanding

Answer the questions below.

1. Why would a cashless society not benefit ordinary people?
2. What would need to happen if hard cash disappeared?
3. Why do some people want to get rid of large banknotes?
4. Why is the UK not planning to move to a cashless society?

5 Find the words

Find a word or phrase in the article which means...

1. involvement in a situation which people want to keep private **(noun, P3)** : _____
2. inappropriate **(adj., P9)** : _____
3. people who avoid doing what they should do **(plural noun, P10)** : _____
4. change **(noun, P12)** : _____
5. as far in the future as you can imagine **(phrase, P15)** : _____

Give your own examples of these words/phrases.

6 Prepositions

Complete the phrases below from the text with suitable prepositions.

1. have control _____ something
2. be vulnerable _____ something
3. be accused _____ a crime
4. get rid _____ something
5. be _____ review

Give your own example sentences with these phrases.

7 Talking point

Would you like to live in a cashless society? Why/why not?

Key

1. Warm-up

Encourage a short discussion.

2. Key words

Give examples where appropriate.

1. cushion
2. vulnerable
3. intercept
4. anonymously
5. capital flow
6. traces
7. snoop

3. Find the information

Students can work individually and check in pairs. Go through the answers with the class.

- ✓ Cash makes it easier to avoid paying taxes.
- ✓ People who pay in cash are less vulnerable to cyber theft and government snooping.
- ✓ Cash creates opportunities for criminals.
- ✓ You can make cash payments anonymously.
- ✓ It's harder for the government to control citizens who use cash.

4. Checking understanding

Students can work individually and check in pairs. Go through the answers with the class.

1. It leaves people vulnerable to government intrusion.
2. There would needs to be limits on how the government can use payment systems to control citizens.
3. Large banknotes are used by criminals.
4. Cash is still very popular in the UK.

5. Find the words

Students can work individually and check in pairs. Go through the answers with the class.

1. intrusion
2. improper
3. dodgers
4. shift
5. for the foreseeable future

6. Prepositions

Students can work individually and check in pairs. Go through the answers with the class.

1. over
2. to
3. of
4. of
5. under

7. Talking point

Encourage a discussion.

BACK TO WORK



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-T57D-96SH

1 Warm up

Do you prefer working in an office or at home? Why/why not?

2 Key words

Study the following sentences and match each underlined word or phrase to its correct definition below.

1. The boss' decision infuriated everyone. Nobody was happy about it.
2. It's not easy to juggle a career and a family.
3. The bosses installed a monitoring system in order not to lose track of what the staff are doing.
4. We had an impromptu meeting while we were chatting by the water cooler.
5. The company's decision seemed like a covert way of increasing productivity.
6. The decision was perplexing — nobody could understand it.

a. confusing, difficult to understand
b. deal with several things at the same time, satisfying all the requirements
c. fail to be fully aware or informed about
d. made (everyone) very angry
e. not openly displayed, secret
f. unplanned

3 Reading

You are going to read an article about working from home. Decide whether the statements are true or false and then check your answers by reading the text.

1. The working-from-home ban was a collective decision by Yahoo! staff members.
2. According to a Yahoo! memo, working from home prevents collaboration.
3. Yahoo! and Google are very close rivals.
4. Yahoo! employs under 11,000 people.
5. Over 50% of British companies offer regular home-working.
6. According to the UK's Chartered Institute of Personnel and Development, people work harder at home.



THE INDEPENDENT

Yahoo! tells its staff to get back in the office

Boss of internet giant bans working from home - weeks after she built childcare facilities in her own office.

1. It could rank as one of the supreme ironies of the internet age. Silicon Valley pioneer Yahoo!, which helped bring the digital communication revolution to the masses, has banned its staff from working from home.
2. The rule has infuriated parents who were previously able to juggle childcare with their careers, and it was the decision of Marissa Mayer, corporate America's most celebrated working mother, who returned to the office just two weeks after giving birth to her first child.
3. A memo sent last week by the company's head of human resources told Yahoo! staff that they had until the summer to get back to the company HQ in Sunnyvale, California, or lose their job. This came after concern that workers were "hiding" from bosses who had lost track of who was supposed to be where and doing what.
4. "To become the absolute best place to work, communication and collaboration will be important, so we need to be working side by side," the memo stated. "That is why it is critical we are all present in our offices. Some of the best decisions and insights come from hallway and cafeteria discussions, meeting new people, and impromptu team meetings."
5. Chief executive Ms Mayer, 37, who once ranked her priorities as God, family and Yahoo!, is charged with turning round the company which has been eclipsed by rivals such as Google. She is said to have become frustrated at the sight of the half-full company car park emptying rapidly at 5pm each day — especially after building her own nursery next to her office to allow her to work longer hours.
6. But one anonymous member of staff said female employees would be hit hardest. "When a working mother is standing behind this, you know we are a long way from a culture that will honour the thankless sacrifices that women too often make," she wrote.
7. Some analysts have suggested the back-to-work order could be a covert way of reducing staff numbers and restoring a competitive work ethic at the company which employs 11,500 people in 20 countries. However, the move was described by Virgin tycoon Sir Richard Branson as "perplexing" and a "backward step".
8. "If you provide the right technology to keep in touch, maintain regular communication and get the right balance between remote and office working, people will be motivated to work responsibly, quickly and with high quality," Sir Richard said.
9. A recent study by the Chartered Institute of Personnel and Development (CIPD) found that flexible employment was now common in British companies, with 54 per cent offering home-working on a regular basis.
10. Ben Willmott, head of public policy at the CIPD, said there was a powerful business case for allowing workers greater freedom.
11. "The evidence shows that where people are able to benefit from flexible working they are more likely to be engaged and work harder," he said. "They have lower levels of stress and are more likely to stay with their company".

Adapted from The Independent, 26 Feb 2013

4 Checking understanding

Answer the questions below.

1. Why did Yahoo! ban working from home?
2. What was Ms Marissa Mayer frustrated about each day?
3. Why was one anonymous female staff member particularly unhappy about the ban?
4. According to some analysts, what could be the real purpose of the ban?
5. According to Richard Branson, how can people be motivated to work hard at home?
6. According to Ben Willmott, what are the benefits of working from home?

5 Find the words

Find a word or phrase in the article which means...

1. very great **(adjective, P1)** _____
2. close together **(phrase, P4)** _____
3. overtaken, made less important (by a competitor) **(verb -ed, P5)** _____
4. competitors **(plural noun, P5)** _____
5. an area for the special use of young children **(noun, P5)** _____
6. (of a job or task) difficult or unpleasant and not really appreciated by others **(adjective, P6)** _____
7. a businessperson of great wealth and power **(noun, P7)** _____
8. deeply involved (in something) **(adjective, P11)** _____

6 Talking point

Discuss any of the questions below.

1. Do you think that working from home is a good idea?
2. What kind of technology does your company use to communicate with remote workers?
3. Does home-working make sense in your line of work?
4. What do you think are the benefits of working in an office compared with working at home?
5. What do you think are the drawbacks of working at home?
6. What do you think is the 'right balance' of remote and office working?

Key

2. Key words

Students can work individually and check in pairs.

1. d
2. b
3. c
4. f
5. e
6. a

3. Reading

1. F
2. T
3. F
4. F
5. T
6. T

4. Checking understanding

1. They were concerned that "hiding" from bosses and that bosses had lost track of their employees' work.
2. the sight of a half-full car park emptying rapidly
3. because it was the decision of a working mother
4. to reduce staff numbers and increase competitiveness
5. with the right technology and balance between remote and office working
6. lower levels of stress, more flexibility

5. Find the words

1. supreme
2. side by side
3. eclipsed
4. rivals
5. nursery
6. thankless
7. tycoon
8. engaged

BASIC INCOME



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-S57B-AUI3

1 Warm-up

Look at the definition below.

a basic income: a payment given to all individuals, usually on a monthly basis, without any means testing

Why do you think that governments are becoming more interested in the idea of giving a basic income?

2 Key vocabulary

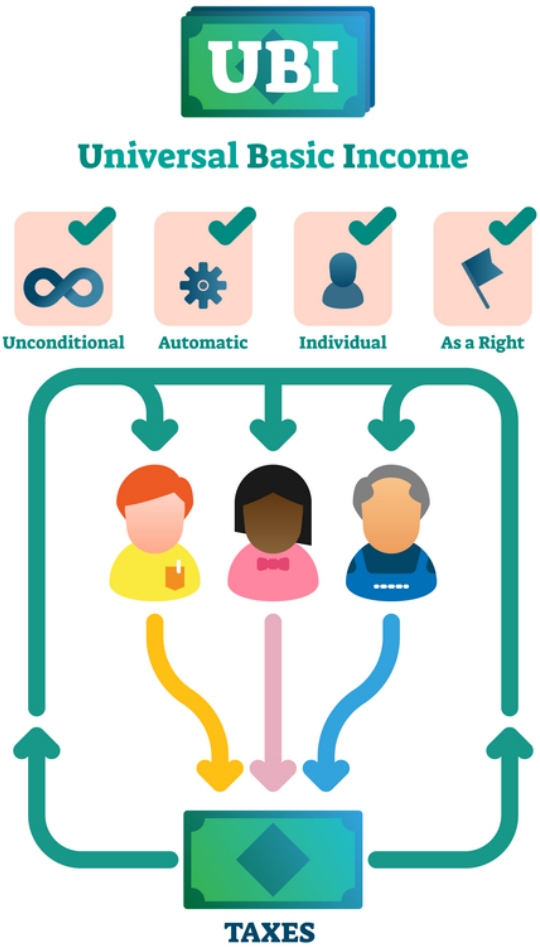
Match the words on the left to their definitions on the right.

1.	unconditional	a.	an amount of money that you are given regularly
2.	an incentive	b.	a person who receives something
3.	pursue	c.	a project used to test an idea before deciding whether to use it more widely
4.	a recipient	d.	a reason that makes you want to do something because it has benefits for you
5.	an allowance	e.	to risk damaging something important
6.	jeopardise	f.	to try to do something over a long period of time
7.	a pilot scheme	g.	without having to meet certain requirements

3 Guess the answers

You are going to read an article about an experiment to test basic income in Finland. Before you read, guess the answers to the questions below, then scan the text on the next page to find the answers.

1. How much was each person given as part of the experiment?
   a. €320 a month b. €560 a month c. €810 a month
2. How many people are part of the trial?
   a. 2,000 b. 5,000 c. 10,000
3. How long will the experiment run for?
   a. 1 year b. 2 years c. 5 years
4. What can people spend the money they are given on?
   a. food and energy bills b. rent or mortgage payments c. anything they want



THE INDEPENDENT

Finnish citizens given universal basic income report lower stress levels and greater motivation to work

Participants receive €560 (£473) every month and do not have to demonstrate that they are actively seeking work

1. Finland has given 2,000 of its citizens an unconditional income, with people reporting benefits within months of starting the experiment. Participants said they experienced less stress, had greater incentives to find work and more time to pursue business ideas.
2. The scheme is the first of its kind in Europe, in which people receive €560 (£473) every month, to continue over a period of two years.
3. Recipients do not have to demonstrate that they are seeking employment and they are not required to regularly report to authorities to prove they still need the payment, which is the case with standard unemployment benefits. They can spend the money however they like.
4. Under the pilot scheme, if a participant finds work, they will continue to receive the allowance, removing one of the limitations of current welfare systems - the disincentive to find work.
5. Juha Jarvinen, an unemployed young father in a village near Jurva, western Finland, was picked at random to receive the payment, starting in January of 2017. He told a magazine that, unlike when he was receiving standard unemployment payments, he is now actively seeking work.
6. He had previously been offered a few part-time positions but taking them would make no sense, since it would jeopardise his welfare payments. "It is crazy, so no one will take a bit of work," he said.
7. He said he is also in the process of starting a business, is much less stressed and no longer has to go through the "silly show" of filling out forms or attending regular interviews with employment agency officials.
8. Not everyone is impressed by the pilot scheme, however. In February, Finland's biggest union said the experiment was unaffordable and would encourage some people to work less while driving up wages in undesirable professions.
9. "We think it takes social policy in the wrong direction," the chief economist of the Central Organisation of Finnish Trade Unions (SAK) told a news agency.

Adapted from the Independent, by Ben Chapman, 21st of June 2017

4 Checking understanding

Read the text again and put 'T' (True) or 'F' (False) next to each statement below. Say why the false answers are not true.

1. People found that being given money meant that they didn't want to find work.
2. Trials of basic income have never been done before in Europe.
3. Recipients of the money have to show every month that they still need a payment.
4. The participants aren't allowed to work and still get an allowance.
5. Industry professionals don't think that the government is financially able to run the scheme.

Do you think that the Finnish government will decide to give all citizens a basic income after the experiment? Read the article on the next page to find out.

5 Reading 2: The results

Finland ends universal basic income trial

The Finnish government has decided to end a two year universal basic income trial and will look into other **welfare** options. The experiment will finish in 2019.

Finland has an unemployment rate of 9.2%, higher than in other Nordic countries, and a complex **benefits** system, which led the government to start changing its benefits strategy. The OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development) thinks that a universal credit system, which is in use in the UK, would work better than a basic income in Finland. Universal credit is given to people as a single monthly **sum**, instead of several benefit payments.

The other option that Finnish politicians are looking at is negative income tax, which is where people whose income falls below a certain **threshold** don't pay income tax, but instead receive payments from the tax office.

The Finnish government want to find a **cost-effective** system which encourages people to work, but does not add to income **inequality**. *Sources: BBC News, The Guardian, 23rd of April, 2018*

Match the words in bold from the article to their definitions below.

1. _____ (noun): an amount of money
2. _____ (noun): a limit at which something changes
3. _____ (noun - plural): money given by a government to people who can't/don't work
4. _____ (noun): a situation where people are not equal because others have more money, power or opportunities
5. _____ (adj.): giving good results without spending a lot of money
6. _____ (noun.): help given by a government to people that need it

6 Talking point

Ask and answer the questions below in pairs or small groups.

1. Do you think that if you didn't have a job and received a basic income, you would be motivated to find work? Do you think you would feel less stressed? Why/why not?
2. What type of benefit system do you have in your country? Do you think that it is a good system?
3. Do you think that more countries may try an experiment with universal basic income? Why/not?
4. Why do you think that the Finnish government decided not to continue the experiment?

7 Discussion

Look at the underlined words in exercise 5, which show different types of benefit strategy. You work for the government. Discuss what you think the advantages and disadvantages of each benefit strategy are, including universal basic income. Then, decide which one you will use.

Key

1. Warm-up

Encourage a short discussion.

2. Key vocabulary

Students can work in pairs and check with the teacher.

1. g 2. d 3. f 4. b 5. a 6. e 7. c

3. Guess the answers

1. b 2. a 3. b 4. c

4. Checking understanding

1. F - They had more incentives to find work.
2. T - The scheme is the first of its kind in Europe.
3. F - They do not have to report to authorities to prove that that they still need a payment.
4. F - The payment does not stop if they find work.
5. T - Finland's biggest union thought that the experiment was 'unaffordable'.

5. Reading 2: The results

Students can work in pairs and check answers with the teacher.

1. sum
2. threshold
3. benefits
4. inequality
5. cost-effective
6. welfare

6. Talking point

Monitor the activity. Make a note of typical errors and write useful vocabulary on the board.

7. Discussion

Work as a class. Students should share their ideas about the advantages and disadvantages of each strategy. You may want to write a few ideas on the board to start the discussion if students are a bit hesitant in the beginning.

COMPETITION



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-S579-9ZLP

1 Key words

Match the words below to their definitions.

1. a consumer	a. a company producing and selling products in several different countries
2. supply	b. a person or a group that competes with others for the same thing
3. a rival	c. a person who buys goods or services for themselves
4. overtake	d. complete control of something by an organization or person
5. a multinational	e. to be as good as somebody or something else
6. regain	f. to get something back that you lost
7. a monopoly	g. to go past something by being better
8. match	h. to provide something that people want or need, often in large quantities

Now put the words from the exercise into the sentences below in the correct form.

1. If customers are not _____ with a certain product, they will go elsewhere.
2. Having a _____ in business is not always a bad thing. It forces you to improve things.
3. _____ have a lot of choice these days. Businesses have to give them added value.
4. We need to _____ the customers we lost to a company that was offering big discounts.
5. If you are a _____ company, you have access to many more customers.
6. We will soon have a _____ in the market. No one is able to challenge us.
7. They were able to _____ their competitor. Both businesses reported similar sales.
8. This year we have _____ our competitors. We are now the market leader.

2 Competition verbs, nouns and adjectives

Complete the table below.

Verb	Noun	Adjective
attract	attraction	attractive
improve	1.	improvable
innovate	innovation	2.
compete	competition	3.
dominate	4.	dominating
produce	5.	productive

3 Competition collocations

Read the text about competition and fill in the gaps with the missing words to create collocations.

advantage brand customers edge market product profits share

Competition between businesses is natural. Each has to win market _____[1], retain _____[2] and increase their _____[3], while keeping one eye on what their competitors are doing. Some people view competition as a bad thing, but it is often essential for businesses to grow and improve their customer service. Becoming the leading _____[4] in a particular field gives a business a clear _____[5]. But when companies are in this position they can't afford to be complacent, as the competition will be right behind them. Knowing their target _____[6] is crucial for continued success, and creating an innovative _____[7] can give a company that all important competitive _____[8].

Now, fill in the gaps with the correct words to make collocations with the word 'competition'.

between domestic face fight off intense

1. There isn't a big market outside the country for our product, but there is a lot of _____ competition.
2. The competition _____ our companies this year became very fierce.
3. We will _____ competition from another company next year, as they are expanding into our market.
4. Airlines that offer cheap flights have to be prepared for _____ competition.
5. The company was able to _____ competition from their rival, as they had a better product.

4 Competition idioms

Match the underlined idiomatic expressions with their correct meaning below.

1. Our business has always been ahead of the curve. We are always planning for the future.
2. We think we can corner the market. No one can compete with us on price.
3. We have great staff who always go the extra mile. That is why we have so many loyal customers.
4. You need to keep your eye on the ball at all times. You never know what the competition will do.
5. We have to raise the bar because the market is very crowded right now.
6. Our manager encourages us to think outside the box. He wants us to be creative.
7. We will blow the competition out of the water this year. We are going to invest more in our services.

a. become so successful at selling a particular product that no other company can sell it
b. better than average, more advanced
c. destroy (something) completely
d. do more and make a lot of effort
e. increase expected standards
f. keep your attention on something
g. think in an imaginative and innovative way

5 Staying ahead of the curve

With a partner or in a small group, brainstorm ideas about how you can stay ahead of your competition in business. Use the lines below to write down your ideas.

.....
.....
.....
.....
.....
.....
.....
.....
.....

6 Great business rivalries: McDonald's vs. Burger King

PART 1: Listen to the descriptions of McDonald's and Burger King. Fill in the missing information in the tables.

Audio MD

Company	McDonald's
Headquarters	Oak Brook, Illinois
Founder(s)	1. Richard and Maurice _____
Year founded	2. _____
Employees (2015)	420,000
Number of locations (2016)	3. _____
Turnover (2015)	US$ 25 billion

Audio BK

Company	Burger King (formerly Insta-Burger King)
Headquarters	4. _____
Founder(s)	David Edgerton and James McLamore
Year founded	1954
Employees (2015)	5. _____
Number of locations (2016)	15,243
Turnover (2015)	6. _____ US$

Audio

Source: Wikipedia

PART 2: Now, listen to the information about their business rivalry, and then answer the questions.

1. How long have McDonald's and Burger King been rivals for?
2. Why did Burger King sell a bigger burger than McDonald's?
3. Why did the 'burger wars' start?
4. Which other fast food chain has been involved in the 'burger wars'?
5. Why did the 'burger wars' make a comeback?
6. What was the joint McDonald's/Burger King burger going to be called?

7 Talking Point

Discuss any of the questions below.

1. Do you agree that competition is good for business? Why/why not?
2. What do you think your company does to give them a competitive advantage?
3. Do you think competition at work between people is a positive thing? Why/why not?

Transcripts

6. Great business rivalries: McDonald's vs. Burger King

McDonald's is the largest hamburger fast food chain in the world. Its turnover in 2015 was a huge 25.413 billion US dollars. It currently has its headquarters in Oak Brook, Illinois. Founded in 1940 by brothers Richard and Maurice McDonald, the restaurant started life as a BBQ drive-in in San Bernardino, California. In 1948, it was reopened as a self-service drive-in. At this time, a hamburger cost 15 cents. In 1954, a salesman named Ray Kroc visited McDonald's. He was fascinated by the company, and in 1955 he bought the chain from the brothers. This was the beginning of the McDonald's Corporation. Its menu is based around hamburgers, chicken products and french fries, but it was expanded to include salads, fish and smoothies, reflecting changing customer tastes. In 2015, over 420,000 staff served over 60 million customers a day. McDonald's now has restaurants in 119 countries and in September 2016 had 36,615 outlets worldwide.

Burger King, the world's second largest hamburger fast food chain, has its headquarters in Miami, Florida. Its turnover in 2015 was 4.05 billion US dollars. The first restaurant opened in 1953 in Jacksonville, Florida, and was named Insta-Burger King. In 1954, two franchisees named David Edgerton and James McLamore bought the company which was in financial trouble, and renamed it Burger King. In 2012, when the company was in trouble again, a Brazilian investment firm named 3G Capital bought a large share of it for 3.26 billion US dollars. Burger King's menu has expanded from just burgers and fries. The Whopper is its signature product, but many of its other products have not done so well in the US market. Overseas these have been more successful, and Burger King also now creates menus for regional tastes. In 2015 it had 34,248 employees, serving food to over 11 million customers a day. As of September 2016, Burger King had 15,243 outlets in 100 countries.

McDonald's vs. Burger King - The 'burger wars': The two dominant players in the hamburger restaurant industry, McDonald's and Burger King, have been rivals for over six decades.

There are only so many things you can do with a burger, so copying your competitors ideas is nothing new. For example, McDonald's created the Big Mac in 1968 to challenge Burger King's Whopper. The Whopper was launched because Burger King knew it couldn't compete with McDonald's 15 cent hamburger, and decided to sell bigger burgers for 37 cents.

The 'burger wars' began in the 1970s, when Burger King criticised the size of McDonald's hamburgers in an advertising campaign. Other chains such as Wendy's in the US, also became involved in the advertising war, and both Burger King's and Wendy's profits were affected as a result. In contrast, McDonald's profits and market share grew.

One campaign in 1982 made a lot of headlines. Burger King declared that customers preferred the Whopper to burgers from McDonald's and Wendy's. Both restaurants sued for false and misleading advertising.

In 1997, another Burger King campaign caused controversy when they said that their fries had "a taste that beats McDonald's." Of course, McDonald's hit back with their own campaign.

When Burger King suffered because of several management changes, McDonald's gained a lot of ground on their competitor.

The 'burger wars' made a comeback because of tough economic times. Consumers were looking for value and the major fast food chains had to compete harder for every dollar. In 2014 McDonald's business declined sharply and Burger King's improved. This was helped by their new burger, the Big King, which looked almost identical to McDonald's Big Mac. In 2015, Burger King challenged McDonald's, via a newspaper ad, to create a burger with them for the International Day of Peace. It was going to be called 'The McWhopper'. The plan was to have a restaurant in Atlanta where employees from both companies would work. But McDonald's rejected the idea, saying that their 'friendly business competition' should not be used in this way. The reaction from the public to McDonald's comments was far from positive.

Key

1. Key words

Students can work in pairs and then check with the teacher.

1. c 2. h 3. b 4. g 5. a 6. f 7. d 8. e

1. supplied 2. rival 3. consumers 4. regain
5. multinational 6. monopoly 7. match 8. overtaken

2. Competition verbs, nouns and adjectives

Students can work in pairs and then check with the teacher. 1. improvement; 2. innovative; 3. competitive; 4. domination; 5. production

3. Competition collocations

Make sure that students understand the meanings of the collocations. Use extra example sentences if necessary.

1. share 2. customers 3. profits 4. brand
5. advantage 6. market 7. product 8. edge

1. domestic 2. between 3. face 4. intense 5. fight off

4. Competition idioms

Make sure that students understand the idioms. Clarify if necessary.

1. b 2. a 3. d 4. f 5. e 6. g 7. c

5. Staying ahead of the curve

Allow students 5 minutes to brainstorm in groups, then come together as a class to share ideas. Some suggestions if students are short of ideas: know your customers, know your competition, do more marketing, update your image, look after any existing customers, plan for the future, make sure your business has a unique selling point and that your customers know what it is, be a great employer, expand what you offer and target new markets.

6. Great business rivalries: McDonald's vs. Burger King

Play the audio files or use your mobile device to scan the QR code. (Make sure you have installed a QR code reader app and can access the Internet on your device). Play them twice if students request it. PART 1: 1. McDonald; 2. 1940; 3. 36,615; 4. Miami, Florida; 5. 34,248; 6. 4.05 billion

PART 2:

1. over six decades
2. because they couldn't compete with the 15 cent hamburger
3. Burger King criticised the size of McDonald's burgers
4. Wendy's
5. because of tough economic times
6. the McWhopper

CORPORATE CRIME



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-T57F-MKID

1 Types of crime

Match the corporate crimes with their definitions. Can you think of any other examples of corporate crime?

1. price fixing	a. giving money to an employee of your potential buyer to secure an advantage over your business competitors
2. false advertising	b. illegally paying less tax than you should pay
3. insider dealing	c. keeping prices at a certain level by secret agreement between competitors
4. tax evasion	d. marketing that gives incorrect information about the nature, characteristics, qualities or geographic origin of a product or service
5. embezzlement	e. reproducing, distributing, displaying or performing something without permission from the creator
6. commercial bribery	f. stealing company money that you were trusted with
7. industrial espionage	g. stealing trade secrets by copying or recording confidential information for use by a competitor
8. copyright infringement	h. using confidential information about a company to buy or sell its shares

2 Punishments

Look at the list of punishments below. In pairs, order them from 1 (most lenient) to 5 (most severe):

a compensation order
a heavy fine
an immediate dismissal
a prison sentence
life imprisonment

3 Talking point

Discuss any of the questions below:

1. Which types of corporate crime do you think are the most serious?
2. Which types of corporate crime do you think are the least serious?
3. Which types of corporate crime are most common in your country?
4. Are the punishments appropriate?
5. Should corporate criminals be punished more severely?
6. Have you ever been asked for a bribe?

4 Corporate scandals

Read the information on the next page and find words and phrases in the text which mean:

1. an operation that pays returns to its investors from existing capital or new capital paid by new investors, rather than from profit earned by the individual or organization running the operation (two-word noun, P1): _____
2. illegally obtain money from someone (verb, P1): _____
3. the crime of altering or falsifying accounting records to improve a company's finances (two-word noun, P2): _____
4. declare legally that you cannot pay your debts to get legal protection from creditors (phrase, P2): _____
5. increase the value of things that the company owns (phrase, P3): _____
6. state that you are unable to pay your debts (phrase, P4): _____
7. a trader who acts independently and without authorization (two-word noun, P4): _____
8. hide a serious mistake or crime (phrasal verb, P4): _____
9. secretly and dishonestly moving company money into a different location (phrase, P5): _____
10. the crime of moving and transferring illegal money to make it seem legal (two-word noun, P5): _____

CORPORATE SCANDALS

Everybody loves to gossip about corporate scandals. Whether they involve greed, bribery, fraud or corruption, big scandals usually make headline news and tend to have a significant impact on the economy. Here are five of the biggest scandals in modern history.

1. **Bernie Madoff Ponzi scheme (1980-2005)**

   Bernie Madoff was an investment adviser and former chairman of the NASDAQ stock market. He operated a massive Ponzi scheme that managed to defraud some of the smartest people in the world of at least $65 billion. Federal investigators believe the fraud began as early as the mid-1980s and may have begun as far back as the 1970s. In 2009, Madoff was convicted of fraud and sentenced to 150 years in prison.

2. **Enron (2001)**

   At the beginning of 2001, the US energy company Enron was the seventh largest company in America. However, in order to make the company seem more profitable than it really was, its directors and executives were hiding large losses with the aid of accounting firm Arthur Andersen. When the accounting fraud was discovered, Enron shares dropped from $90 to $0.50, the company was forced to file for bankruptcy. Many of its directors eventually went to prison.

3. **Worldcom (2002)**

   In another US accounting scandal, WorldCom, the second largest US long-distance phone company, filed for bankruptcy in 2002. After falling share prices, it was found that the directors had used fraudulent accounting methods to push up the stock price and inflate the companies assets by over $11 billion. In 2004, the company was eventually purchased by Verizon Communications and rebranded.

4. **Barings Bank (1995)**

   Barings Bank was the oldest merchant bank in London, founded in 1762 by the German Baring family. In 1995, the bank had to declare insolvency after suffering losses of £827 million ($1.3 billion) as a result of poor investments by an employee named Nick Leeson. The rogue trader tried to cover up his mistakes but he was caught and sentenced to 6.5 years in prison. While in prison, Leeson published an autobiography which was eventually made into a film in 1999.

5. **Parmalat (2002-2005)**

   Parmalat SpA is a multinational Italian dairy and food corporation. In 2003 , a €14 billion hole was discovered in the company's accounting records and its founder Calisto Tanzi was accused of diverting company funds. Hundreds of thousands of investors lost their money and the company became the largest bankruptcy in European history. Tanzi was charged with financial fraud and money laundering and was sentenced to 10 years in prison.

Which of the scandals is the biggest in your opinion? Why?

Key

1. Types of crime

Students can work individually and check in pairs. If you are teaching a large class, split the students into small groups for the discussion part. Monitor the activity and provide feedback. Other examples of corporate crime could include 'sale of unsafe products', 'money laundering'.

1. c 2. d 3. h 4. b 5. f 6. a 7. g 8. e

2. Punishments

Go through the punishments and explain any terms the students are unfamiliar with. Compensation and heavy fines usually apply to the corporation whereas the other punishments apply to individuals. Possible answer:

1 - an immediate dismissal, 2 - a heavy fine, 3 - a compensation order, 4 - a prison sentence, 5 - life imprisonment

4. Corporate scandals

During or after the exercise, point out the important difference between 'filing for bankruptcy' (a legal procedure which aims to stop creditors from chasing money from you) and 'declaring insolvency' (enter a financial situation in which you cannot currently meet your debts). Insolvency can lead to bankruptcy if urgent measures are not taken to rectify the situation.

1. a Ponzi scheme
2. defraud
3. accounting fraud
4. file for bankruptcy
5. inflate the company's assets
6. declare insolvency
7. rogue trader
8. cover up
9. diverting company funds
10. money laundering

CULTURAL KNOW-HOW



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-U57E-ZV62

1 Idioms

Study the following sentences and match each underlined idiom to its correct definition below.

1. At the end of the meal, we decided to go Dutch.
2. If you want to win the argument, you should stick to your guns.
3. Thank you for all your help. I hope someday we can return the compliment.
4. The politician managed to save face by escaping blame for the mistake.
5. Everyone at the party was wearing special costumes, and we had to follow suit.
6. During the negotiation, they decided to give ground in order to reach an agreement.
7. We were wined and dined all over the city.
8. I was trying to be polite, but he got the wrong idea.

a. change your position in order to make it easier to reach an agreement
b. do something for someone because they have done something for you
c. do what other people are doing
d. keep your position even if people try to criticize you
e. misunderstood
f. pay 50% of the bill each
g. protect your reputation
h. taken out for expensive meals

2 Cultural etiquette

Decide whether the statements are true or false and then check your answers by reading the article.

1. In Singapore, the word ‘no’ is considered impolite.
2. In Greece, you should nod your head upwards to say ‘yes’.
3. In Italy, it is a bad idea to turn up late for a meeting.
4. In the Netherlands, it is a bad idea to turn up late for a meeting.
5. In Japan, the business card is very important and should be treated with respect.
6. In Russia, you should not argue during business deals.
7. In Turkey, you should not insist on sharing the restaurant bill with your host.
8. In Mexico, you should be careful about proposing dinner arrangements with your client.



THE INDEPENDENT

Cultural know-how

Learning about a country's culture can help you secure good working relations on your travels.

1. Do you arrive 10 minutes early for an important business meeting in Rio or 10 minutes late in Amsterdam? In Moscow, is it a good idea to give ground at an early stage of the negotiations? And in Istanbul, should you offer to go Dutch with the host on the restaurant bill?
2. Mastering the local etiquette can be more valuable than learning the language, because so much of the world does business in English. Or a form of English. "Beware that an English word or phrase doesn't always mean the same thing abroad," warns Michael Bennett, who sells security systems in South East Asia. "In Japan and Singapore, people feel that 'no' is an impolite word, and will sometimes say 'yes' to avoid causing offence. What they really mean is 'I understand what you're saying', not 'I agree'. I'm told that in Indonesia there are 12 words for 'yes' that mean precisely the opposite."
3. Even the movement of your head can be open to misinterpretation. Publisher Robin Touquet has had difficulties in Athens: "The Greeks traditionally use an upward nod of the head to say 'no', and a tilt of the head from side to side to mean 'yes'. I was ready for that, but didn't realise the younger generation have learnt to do it our way. Confusion all round. If in doubt, keep still."
4. The issue of punctuality is almost as complicated. Oil company executive Malcolm Thorburn deliberately turns up a few minutes late for meetings in Brazil "because Brazilians believe latecomers are more likely to be commercially successful than people who arrive early. They're impressed by people who are relaxed enough not to worry about the clock. The Italians take a similar attitude. They believe that arriving late shows who is the boss." However, don't risk that in the Netherlands. "The Dutch frown upon lateness," warns film finance agent James Hindle: "They believe that people who can't use their time wisely cannot be trusted."
5. Hindle has also experienced the ceremony of exchanging business cards in Japan. "The business card is seen as representing the individual, so the whole affair has to be treated with respect. You must accept your client's card with both hands, perhaps admiring it, and then place it carefully in your cardholder."
6. The social side of Japanese commerce can also unnerve the western visitor, who might have to go to a karaoke bar and sing. "Many Japanese businessmen like to conclude business by performing their favourite song in a karaoke bar," says management trainer Nicole Wehden. "You're expected to follow suit."
7. In Russia, the ritual of the business meeting is more theatrical skill. " I've seen temper tantrums, sudden walkouts, table-thumping and so on, but it's all part of the fun," says Michael Bennett. "And they admire you more if you stick to your guns. Seeking a compromise early is seen as a sign of weakness."
8. In almost every business community around the world, the host pays for the meal. Malcolm Thorburn was wined and dined in Istanbul, and all went well until he insisted on paying his share: "It caused real embarrassment, " he recalls. "In Turkey, the idea of sharing a bill is quite alien. The best policy is to thank your host and return the compliment at the first opportunity."
9. Insurance underwriter Toni Morrison caused supper-time embarrassment in Mexico five years ago. "I was working late with a client, and midway through the evening I felt so hungry I suggested we carry on working at a nearby restaurant. The client thought this was a sign I had a romantic interest in him. When I realised he'd got the wrong idea I started to laugh, which made things even worse. The only way of getting out of it was to enable him to save face, so I accepted all the blame for the misunderstanding."

Adapted from The Independent, 18 June 2007

3 Find the words

Find a word or phrase in the article which means...

1. offending people **(phrase, P2)** _____
2. understood incorrectly **(phrase, P3)** _____
3. an upward or downward movement of the head **(noun, P3)** _____
4. do not move **(phrase, P3)** _____
5. people who arrive late **(noun, P4)** _____
6. disapprove of **(phrasal verb, P4)** _____
7. make someone feel nervous or uncomfortable **(verb, P6)** _____
8. sudden periods of uncontrolled childish anger **(plural noun, P7)** _____

4 Grammar - Modal verbs for advice, possibility and necessity

Look at the following sentences from the text and answer the questions below.

> **Should** you offer to go Dutch with the host on the restaurant bill?
> The social side of Japanese commerce **can** also unnerve the western visitor, who **might** have to go to a karaoke bar and sing.
> ...the whole affair **has to** be treated with respect.
> You **must** accept your client's card with both hands.

1. Which modal verb means that something is generally possible?
2. Which modal verb means that something is possible, although not very likely?
3. Which modal verb means 'it is a good idea'?
4. Which two modal verbs express an obligation?
5. What is the negative form of each modal verb?
6. What are the positive and negative past forms of **might** and **should**?
7. What are the positive and negative past forms of **have to** and **must** (used for obligation)?
8. What other modal verb expresses obligation? what are the negative and past forms?
9. What is the difference between these two sentences?
   I **must** get some sleep.
   I **have to** get some sleep.
10. What is the difference between these two sentences?
    I **don't have to** get up early tomorrow.
    I **mustn't** get up late tomorrow.
11. What other modal verbs express possibility and speculation? What are the past forms?

5 Grammar practice - Modals (present forms)

Rewrite the sentences below using a suitable modal verb:

Example: It is a good idea to arrive on time for meetings in the Netherlands.
You should arrive on time for meetings in the Netherlands.

1. Calling your new boss by his first name is not a good idea in this country.
2. Parking your car in the manager's parking space is not allowed.
3. The company dress code is very relaxed, so it is not necessary to wear a suit and tie for the meeting.
4. If you don't learn about the country's culture, there is a slight chance that you will cause someone offence on your business trip.
5. There is a general possibility of offending someone if you ignore cultural etiquette.
6. I'm feeling rather tired. It is necessary for me to go to bed now.
7. It is necessary for me to get up early tomorrow because I start work at 8 o'clock.
8. If you want to do successful business in Russia, it is a good idea to stick to your guns during negotiations.
9. If Sam keeps arriving late for work, there is a possibility that he will get the sack.
10. Karina has been very stressed lately. It is necessary for her to take a holiday.

6 Grammar practice - Modals (Past forms, speculating)

Complete the following sentences with a suitable past form of should, may, might, could, couldn't, can't, must + the verb in brackets

Example: Duncan looked rather upset. He must have misunderstood (misunderstand) me.

1. Michael's meeting in the Netherlands didn't go so well. He _____ (arrive) so late for the meeting.
2. Margaret failed her exam again. She _____ (study) harder.
3. We didn't receive your last invoice. You _____ (send) it to the wrong address.
4. Emilio _____ (move) abroad. I saw him just yesterday!
5. The new deal we signed wasn't particularly cost-effective. With more careful preparation, we _____ (negotiate) a much better price.
6. ABC's advertising campaign looks very similar to ours. They _____ (copy) our campaign.
7. Angelo is having problems with his English. He _____ (join) the company English course last year.
8. I didn't hear the phone ring. I _____ (be) asleep.
9. 'I can't find my car keys.' 'You _____ (leave) them in the office.'
10. You _____ (attend) the business development conference last month. It was probably the most interesting and useful conference I've been to all year.

7 Grammar practice - Modals past and present

Work in pairs. For each of the situations below, use past and present modal verbs to speculate on what went wrong, how the situation should have been dealt with correctly, and on the possible consequence of the mistake.

Example: During negotiations with a potential customer from Singapore, Carl said 'no' to several important propositions. It has been a week now and he hasn't heard anything. He is worried that the potential customer has decided to make a deal with one of his competitors.
Answer: Carl might lose the deal. The potential customer may have been offended. In Singapore, 'no' is considered an impolite word. Carl should have learnt something about the culture in order to be better prepared for the meeting.

1. Simon, the representative of an American manufacturing company, had arranged an important meeting in Rio with a group of Brazilian businessmen to discuss their possible investment in his company's new business plan. When the Brazilians arrived at the conference room, Simon was already there waiting for them. He had turned up 20 minutes early.
2. James, an architect from Britain, turned up 10 minutes late for an important meeting with a potential client in Amsterdam. James' firm is well-established in the market and offered a better price than his competitors. However, now the Dutch client isn't replying to his follow-up emails.
3. Paolo, an electronics distributor in Italy, is in the middle of an important meeting with the representative of a potential Japanese supplier in Tokyo. During the exchange of business cards at the beginning of the meeting, Paolo took the representative's card, folded it in two and slipped it into his back pocket. The Japanese negotiator seemed less friendly after that.
4. During a business dinner in Turkey, Peter tried to insist on paying his share of the bill. His host went quiet and appeared a little red in the face.

8 Talking point

What etiquette advice would you give to a foreign visitor seeking to do business in your country? Try to use some vocabulary from this lesson.
Have you or a visitor ever had any difficulties during a meeting or trip abroad? How could you or your visitor have been better prepared?

Key

If the students work in a cross-cultural environment, encourage a short warm-up discussion on the cultural differences in the habits and behaviour of the people they work or do business with.

This can also be done as a pair work exercise.

1. f 2. d 3. b 4. g 5. c 6. a 7. h 8. e

Ask students questions using some of the idioms, e.g. 'Do you usually go Dutch with your friends/colleagues?', 'Have you ever been wined and dined', 'If you went to a karaoke bar with your colleagues and they started singing, would you follow suit?' etc.

2. Cultural etiquette

1. True 2. False 3. False 4. True
5. True 6. False 7. True 8. True

NOTE: The statement about Mexico should be treated as a joke. Obviously, Toni Morrison's personal experience does not reflect the cultural etiquette of Mexico in particular.

3. Find the words

1. causing offence
2. open to misinterpretation
3. nod
4. keep still
5. latecomers
6. frown upon
7. unnerve
8. temper tantrums

4. Grammar - Modal verbs for advice, possibility and necessity

1. can
2. might
3. should
4. must, has to
5. might not, shouldn't, can't, don't/doesn't have to, mustn't
6. might/might not have + PAST PARTICIPLE, should/shouldn't have + PAST PARTICIPLE
7. had to/didn't have to, had to/wasn't allowed to
8. need to, don't need to/needn't, needed to, didn't need to
9. Must generally refers to a personal, 'internal' obligation, whereas have to generally refers to an external obligation (an external reason why something is necessary such as a timetable constraint, a law, the weather, etc.
10. Don't have to refers to a lack of obligation (i.e. something is not necessary), whereas mustn't refers to an obligation not to do something (i.e. something is forbidden)
11. could (couldn't/could have/couldn't have), may (may not/may have/may not have), can't (can't have)

5. Grammar practice - Modals (present forms)

Suitable answers:

1. You shouldn't call your new boss by his first name in this country.
2. You mustn't park your car in the manager's parking space.
3. The company dress code is very relaxed, so you don't have to wear a suit and tie for the meeting.
4. If you don't learn about the country's culture, you might cause someone offence on your business trip.
5. You can offend someone if you ignore cultural etiquette.
6. I'm feeling rather tired. I must go to bed now.
7. I have to get up early tomorrow because I start work at 8 o'clock.
8. If you want to do successful business in Russia, you should stick to your guns during negotiations.
9. If Sam keeps arriving late for work, he could get the sack.
10. Karina has been very stressed lately. She needs to take a holiday

6. Grammar practice - Modals (Past forms, speculating)

When students get stuck, prompt an appropriate modal verb, e.g. TEACHER: 'Was it a good idea that Michael arrived late for the meeting?' STUDENT: 'No. So, he shouldn't have arrived late.' Suitable answers:

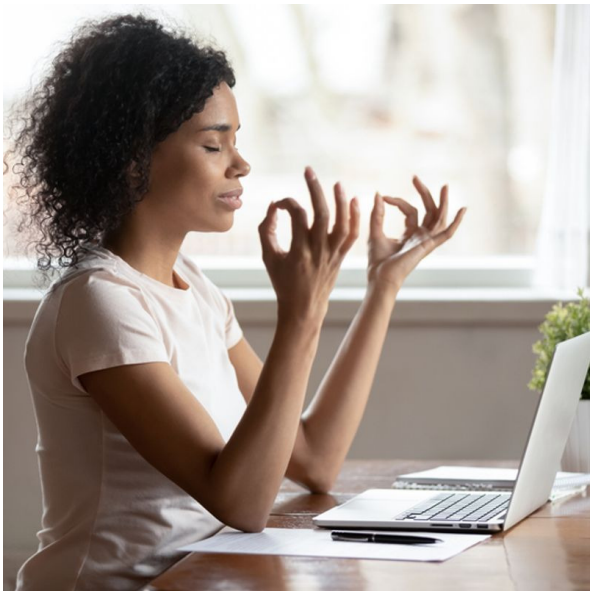
1. shouldn't have arrived
2. should have studied
3. must have sent
4. can't have moved
5. could have negotiated
6. might have copied
7. should have joined
8. must have been
9. could have left
10. should have attended

7. Grammar practice - Modals past and present

Possible answers:

1. Simon shouldn't have arrived so early. The Brazilians might be cautious about doing business with him now. In Brazil, latecomers are considered more likely to be successful in business.
2. The Dutch firm may have frowned upon James' lateness. They may decide to hire one of his competitors instead. James should have been punctual for the meeting.
3. Paolo may have offended the Japanese supplier. In Japan, the exchange of business cards should be treated with respect. He should have been better prepared for the meeting. It might be harder for him now to secure a good deal now.
4. Peter must have embarrassed his host. He shouldn't have tried to insist on paying. In Turkey, you should let your host pay the bill.

EMBRACING EMOTIONS AT WORK



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-S57E-KZZ8

1 Warm up

Look at these three people answering the question, "How was your weekend?" How do you feel about these people? What do you think about their answers?



It was good thanks, And yours?



It was great thanks! We took the kids swimming which they loved! You know the new swimming pool in the centre of town? Then we watched this silly Ben Stiller film that always makes me laugh and ate pizza. Yesterday, we just caught up on sleep and went for a walk. How about you?



It was OK, I guess. We went to this new Mexican restaurant near us and I had the nachos. I don't know what was in them, but it gave me really bad wind. My wife told me we should have gone to the Italian place so had no sympathy. But Italian food always gives me heartburn.

Look at the following emotions in the box. With a partner, discuss if they are acceptable emotions to display in a professional environment in your culture, and if so, in what situation would they be appropriate?

Anger	**Sadness**	**Joy**
Jealousy	**Fear**	**Anxiety**

Which of these emotions would you display in your professional environment?

2 Vocabulary development

Look at these phrases from the video. With a partner, discuss what they mean. When you have finished, check your answers with your teacher or on the Internet.

1. Being stoic
2. More ... than they bargained for
3. Undermine yourself
4. A wide spectrum of ...
5. Under-emoters/Over-emoters
6. Selective vulnerability
7. Flag your feelings
8. A looming deadline
9. Read the room
10. Prone to doing something

In pairs, answer these questions.

1. Would you describe yourself or someone you know as **stoic**? How do you/they behave?
2. Can you describe a situation where you **got more** of something **than** you **bargained for**?
3. In what ways do you sometimes **undermine yourself**? Has anyone ever undermined you? What happened?
4. Would you describe yourself as an **under-emoter** or an **over-emoter**? Why?
5. What action can you take to **flag your feelings**?
6. How do you react to **a looming deadline**?
7. What can you do to **read the room**?
8. What things are you **prone to doing** in your daily life?

3 Watching for general understanding

Watch the video and answer these questions.

1. The speaker says that we work better together when ...
   a. we present ourselves as professionals at all times.
   b. we allow colleagues to see our human side.
   c. we share all of our feelings at work.

2. The first way the speaker suggests to show your emotions is ...
   a. if you're in a bad mood due to something outside of work, acknowledge it and reassure colleagues that it's not about them.
   b. tell your colleagues exactly why you are in a bad mood.
   c. don't tell anyone if you're in a bad mood because they are contagious.

3. The second suggestion the speaker has is ...
   a. get other people to help you with your deadlines.
   b. stop communicating with your colleagues if you are stressed.
   c. analyse what your emotions are telling you and what needs you have.

4. She suggests that you should share your feelings if ...
   a. it will make you feel better and you will be able to do your job better.
   b. it will make your colleagues feel more supported and understand the situation.
   c. you have a deadline and you are feeling really stressed about it.

5. Her final suggestion is ...
   a. to understand how people feel and give them a way to move forward with their work.
   b. if you're having a difficult time, tell your boss about everything.
   c. have a party for everyone so they will see you as a fun person.



4 Watching for detail

Now watch the video again and complete these notes on the talk with no more than three words.

Pervasive myth = emotions don't belong at work _____[1] = stoic, cold.

Research shows when colleagues are more human, show emotions, we _____[2] them more.

However, sharing builds trust / _____[3] .

Emotional expression is a wide _____[4] .

One side = over-emoters, other side = under-emoters. Balance? _____[5] .

Four ways to start:

1. Flag your feelings. Bad moods are _____[6] . If it's nothing to do with work, just point out that you are having a _____[7] .

2. If it is work related try to understand the need _____[8] . Try to take positive action to deal with it.

3. If you want to share your feelings, see it from the other person's point of view. If what you want to say will help them _____[9] and feel more supported, then share. If not, don't.

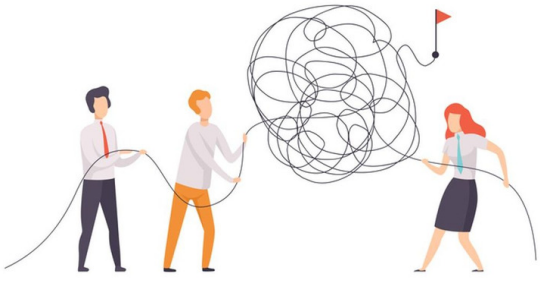
4. Try to understand how people in the office are feeling, and provide _____[10] . Acknowledge the efforts of others and show _____[11] .

Look back at the warm-up activity. Which person was:

a. an under-emoter?

b. an over-emoter?

c. practising selective vulnerability?



5 Talking point

In pairs, practise one of the following role plays. Remember the steps from the talk and try to use the advice given in the roleplay.

Role play 1

Person A	Person B
You need to ask Person B if they can stay later to help you complete some work that will help you hit a deadline. You are feeling very stressed about the situation. You should approach Person B and ask them for help.	You've been working long hours recently and you are tired because one of your children was ill during the night.

Role play 2

Person C	Person D
It's the end of the week. You have an upset stomach and you want to ask Person D, your supervisor, if you can leave early today. It has been a very busy week and you have stayed late several nights this week.	It's been a really long week and you are tired. Your car hasn't been working very well and you think you may have to get it fixed over the weekend. Your team needs to complete the project by the middle of next week. They have all been working hard, but you are still concerned that it may not be enough.

Transcripts

3. Watching for general understanding

Narrator: No matter how hard you might try, you can't just flip a switch when you step into the office and turn your emotions off. Feeling feelings is part of being human.

Narrator: A pervasive myth exists that emotions don't belong at work, and this often leads us to mistakenly equate professionalism with being stoic or even cold. But research shows that in the moments when our colleagues drop their glossy professional presentation, we're actually much more likely to believe what they're telling us. We feel connected to the people around us. We try harder, we perform better and we're just generally kinder. So it's about time that we learn how to embrace emotion at work.

Narrator: Now, that's not to say you should suddenly become a feelings fire hose. A line exists between sharing, which builds trust, and oversharing, which destroys it. If you suddenly let your feelings run wild at work and give people far more information than they bargained for, you make everyone around you uncomfortable and you also undermine yourself. You're more likely to be seen as weak or lacking self-awareness, so, great to say you weren't feeling well last night – you don't need to go into every lurid detail about how you got reacquainted with your half-digested dinner.

Narrator: So there's a wide spectrum of emotional expression. On one hand, you have under-emoters, or people who have a hard time talking about their feelings, and on the other end are over-emoters, those who constantly share everything that's going on inside, and neither of these make for a healthy workplace.

Narrator: So what's the balance between these two extremes? It's something called selective vulnerability. Selective vulnerability is opening up while still prioritising stability and psychological safety, both for you and for your colleagues. Luckily, anyone can learn to be selectively vulnerable, with practice.

Narrator: Here are four ways to get started. First, flag your feelings without becoming emotionally leaky. Bad moods are contagious, and even if you're not vocalising what you're feeling, chances are your body language or your expressions are a dead giveaway. So if you are crossing your arms or hammering on your keyboard, your coworkers are going to know you're upset. And if you don't say anything, they might start to think it's about them and get worried. So if you are reacting to a non-work-related event, so traffic for example, just flag it. You don't need to go into detail. You can say something as simple as "I'm having a bad morning. It has nothing to do with you." Now if it's a work-related event that's causing you to feel strong emotions, that brings us to point number two.

Narrator: Try to understand the need behind your emotion, and then address that need. If you suddenly start to find everyone around you irritating, sit back and reflect on that. And it might be that you're irritable because you're anxious, and you're anxious because you're worried about hitting a looming deadline. And in that case, you can go back to your team to address that need and say something like, "I want to make sure I get everything done ahead of the deadline. Can you help me put together a realistic plan to do that?" If you're thinking of sharing, try and put yourself in the other person's shoes. So if what you're about to say would help you feel more supported and better understand the situation, then go ahead and share it. But if it gives you any kind of pause, you might want to leave it out.

Narrator: And finally, read the room and provide a path forward. If everyone on your team has been pulling long hours, and you notice that one of your colleagues seems particularly deflated or anxious, you can acknowledge that and show some empathy, but then try to give them something actionable that they could hold on to. And in this case, you could suggest that you go to your manager and ask that your weekly meeting be pushed back a day so you both have more time to work. You're showing you're invested in their success, but also that you care about their well-being.

Narrator: When we can be honest about what we feel, and freely suggest ideas, make mistakes and just not have to hide every piece of who we are, we're much more likely to stay at the company for a long time. We're also happier and more productive.

Narrator: So take a moment to reflect on the emotional expression that you bring to work each day. And if you are prone to oversharing, try editing. And if you're a little bit more reserved, look for moments when you can open up to your colleagues and be a bit vulnerable. And chances are, there will be a big difference in how people respond to you. And selective vulnerability might just become one of your most valuable tools.

Key

1. Warm up

10 mins.

The students will be talking about emotions at work. You will need to use your judgement based on your relationship with the class as to how personal you make the examples.

Put the students in pairs or small groups and ask them to discuss the three different answers to the question. You may want to ask them what kind of answer they would typically give to the questions and if it would differ with different colleagues.

When they have completed this, ask them for feedback and see if there is a consensus amongst the class or if it differs depending on cultural background. Then ask them to discuss the different emotions in the box. You may want to ask them if they have witnessed those emotions being expressed in others. Depending on your relationship with the class, you could ask if they have experienced any of those emotions at work and what they did about it.

Again, ask for feedback either as a class or chat with individual pairs or groups.

Students' own answers.

2. Vocabulary development

15 mins.

Ask the students to look at the phrases and speculate on their meaning. You may want to point out that *Stoicism* is a Greek philosophy and approach to life which is where the word comes from. You could also add that that the speaker is American and phrases such as *flag your feelings* and *read the room* are more common in American English than British English, although they will be understood in British English. You can ask the students to research their own answers or to return to their guesses once they have watched the video. Once they have the answers, you can ask them to discuss the questions, again feeding back to the class or as a group.

1. being calm and almost without any emotion
2. more of something than expected
3. To do something that weakens your position or ability to do something
4. A large number of choices or possibilities
5. People who show too little emotion/too much emotion
6. People who carefully choose when and when not to show emotion
7. to acknowledge how you feel
8. A deadline that is in the near future, gives the idea that it is causing concern
9. Attempt to understand how people in the room are feeling generally
10. Something you often or easily do, usually something a little negative, e.g, I'm prone to looking at my phone during a film.

3. Watching for general understanding

5 mins.

Depending on the level of your class, you may want to ask the students to guess the answers to the general questions first, watch the video to check their answers, and then move on to the Watching for detail exercise. Alternatively, you may feel they are capable of completing both exercises simultaneously. Either way, it is a good idea to ask the students to predict the answers to the multiple choice questions before listening.

1. b 2. a 3. c 4. b 5. a

4. Watching for detail

10 - 15 mins.

Ask the students to watch the video and complete the notes. You may want them to guess the words which will fill the gaps ahead of watching. Note that the gaps could be filled by 1, 2, or 3 words. When this is complete, ask them to look back at the warm-up activity and decide on how to classify the speakers at the beginning of the lesson.

1. professionalism
2. believe
3. oversharing destroys it
4. spectrum
5. Selective vulnerability
6. contagious
7. bad morning
8. behind your emotion
9. understand the situation
10. a path forward
11. some empathy

Answers to the second part:

a. Person 1 b. Person 3 c. Person 2

5. Talking point

Up to 20 mins.

You may want to assign your students a situation or let them choose. Depending on the class, you may want to ask them to write down the role-play or they could just improvise it, depending on what they are most comfortable with. You could ask each pair/group to perform their roleplay for the class, or just for you depending on what the students find most comfortable.

Be aware that not all students are comfortable performing for an audience so you should use your judgement as to what you ask them to do.

When you have finished, you may want to ask the groups to discuss how they could use the four rules presented in the talk to improve their work-life and perhaps revisit past situations to see what they or others could have done differently. Monitor the task and help students if they need some ideas to begin.

Students' own answers.

FAILING UP



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-R579-ZNUU

1 Warm up

In pairs, ask each other the following interview questions.

1. ☐ How would your co-workers describe you?
2. ☐ What would you say are your greatest strengths?
3. ☐ Tell me about a time when you made a mistake.
4. ☐ How would your boss describe you?
5. ☐ What would you say are your greatest weaknesses?
6. ☐ What type of work environment do you prefer?
7. ☐ Can you tell me about a time when there was a conflict with a colleague and how it was resolved?

Now, listen to the interviews and tick the questions from above that you hear.



2 Listening comprehension

Complete the table by ticking the box depending on if the statement is "True" for the man or the woman.

Who...	man	woman
a) empathises with people's needs?		
b) is competitive?		
c) embraces learning new skills?		
d) once had difficulty with a financial document?		
e) wants to help the team?		
f) relaxes by playing a sport?		
g) works out of office hours?		
h) has not got on with a colleague?		

Now in pairs discuss the following questions.

1. Who would you prefer as your manager? Why?
2. Who do you think your senior management would choose as a manager? Why?
3. What qualities do you think you need to be successful in management in your company?



3 Focus on vocabulary

Part A: Match the vocabulary to the definitions.

1.	inadvertently (adv.)	a.	confidently expressing opinions and ideas in a noticeable way
2.	intimidating (adj.)	b.	the ability someone has to complete a task successfully
3.	scrutiny (n)	c.	the very careful inspection of something
4.	assertive (adj.)	d.	the state of being neither very good nor very bad
5.	competence (n)	e.	be able to deal with negative situations or opinions or pain
6.	tolerate (v)	f.	in a way that was not planned
7.	thrive (v)	g.	making people lose confidence or feel scared
8.	mediocrity (n)	h.	do well and continue to get better

Part B: Now complete the following sentences with a different part of speech to the word from Part A in brackets.

1. While his interruption of her presentation was _____, it did signal his generally negative attitude towards her. (inadvertently)
2. The manufacturer's business style has been called into question, with accusations of fraud and using lawyers for the _____ of competitors. (intimidating)
3. Her work wasn't always very thorough and I often had to _____ it carefully to check she hadn't overlooked anything, which she often had. (scrutiny)
4. Before we start, I'd like to _____ some facts about the situation in which we find ourselves. (assertive)
5. He has no idea about any part of the business at all, he's completely _____ and only got the job because of who his father is. (competence)
6. She's a good manager, but very _____ of, what she sees as, laziness or lack of care with work. (tolerate)
7. It used to be a _____ industry, but technology has driven away many of the jobs, and now it's quite hard to make any money. (thrive)
8. I didn't hate the conference, but I thought it was quite _____. It needed more money spent on it and better planning. (mediocrity)

Now in pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. What kind of people do you find the most **intimidating**? Why?
2. Is your work often subject to **scrutiny**? Or are you usually left to be responsible for the quality?
3. Under what type of management do you think you're most likely to **thrive**? Why?

4 Skimming for gist

Quickly read the following extracts from the article on page five and decide which gaps (a-f) they should go in. You will not need all of the extracts.



1. Once there, they are more likely to be allowed to fail. _____
2. It's worth asking then, why are women not offered the same type of privilege? _____
3. The ability to fail is, more often than not, the preserve of White males. _____
4. For example, women had to walk the line between not dressing up too much so as not to seem like they thought too much of themselves but also having to make an effort. _____
5. Having made several mistakes, they are then able to do better next time. _____
6. As a result, the pilot show ended up being rewritten, recast and reshot before it was finally ready. _____
7. If they do, they face more serious consequences. _____
8. Candidates, it was found, stand a greater chance of being successful if they look similar to the hiring manager. _____



Failing up

Who can and can't make mistakes?

1. At the Austin Film Festival in 2019, David Benioff and DB Weiss, the creators of the successful series Game of Thrones, inadvertently started a conversation. During an interview, they explained that when they started writing the show, although they had written before, neither of them had experience writing for television. **(a)** _____ They admittedly made mistakes which they learned from and the show went on to become a worldwide phenomenon. While we can all understand the benefit of making, and then learning from mistakes, it was pointed out that in the world of business and elsewhere, not everyone is able to do this. **(b)** _____

2. Research by Christy Glass and Alison Cook of the University of Utah detailed the different experiences that Black people, Indigenous people, people of colour and women generally had in the workplace. They found that everything; from how they dressed, to how they behaved, to how they expressed themselves, were judged much more severely than it was in White men. **(c)** _____ A Black man they spoke to who happened to be 6 foot 8, spoke of how he always arrived early to meetings so that he was sitting down when he spoke to people to avoid appearing intimidating. In short, when so much of what these groups of people do and how they look is under increased scrutiny, they don't have the luxury of making mistakes. **(d)** _____

3. In 2019, Leadership Quarterly published the results of several studies showing that a display of overconfidence was much more likely to be seen as a quality for management positions, despite the fact that it wasn't compatible with the actual skills required to be a good leader. Making eye contact, being an extrovert, being assertive and having confident body language are all aspects that make a difference, even though they are no guarantee of competence. They are also more likely to be found in men than women. **(e)** _____ With this in mind, we can see how white men can steadily get channelled to the top positions. **(f)** _____ Hiring managers have a personal investment in people they have taken on. The success of someone they have promoted is their success. So, they are more likely to tolerate their failures as part of a long-term strategy. For everyone to thrive in the workplace, it's vital that these norms are challenged. By failing to do so, companies risk promoting mediocrity and losing out on the wide range of skills from all of its members, particularly the more humble, and those who happen to be in the racial or gender minority.

Sources: BBC, Online Library

5 Reading comprehension

Complete the summary of the article on page five with one, two or three words.

While _____[1] is a recognised part of education the world over, it seems that, in the world of business, not everyone has equal ability to do so. In recent research, women, people of colour, Black and _____[2] people were found to have a markedly different experience from White men. In short, they were found to be judged more harshly and faced greater consequences when they did make errors of judgement, whereas white men often had the _____[3] failing and then learning from it. Men frequently exhibit _____[4], a trait that often leads to management positions even though it does not sit well with the actual task of management. Additionally, men in positions of power are far more likely to hire someone who looks like them, the result being that White men are _____[5] into all of the senior positions and secure them for future generations of White men. It is important to question these _____[6] and to put policies in place which allow everyone equal access to management. Doing so will ensure the company and all of its employees can thrive.



6 Talking point

In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. What is your reaction to the article? Do you think it is a fair point which is being made? Why/Why not?
2. Do you think everyone has an equal chance to enter management in your company regardless of sex or colour? Why/Why not?
3. Have you witnessed or been the subject of any type of prejudice in your opinion? What happened?
4. If you run your own international company, what could you do to ensure that senior management was occupied by people of a range of genders and races?

7 Extended activity / Homework

Read the essay question.

The only thing that matters when hiring someone is asking yourself: can they do the job? Worrying about what gender, race, colour or anything else they are is ridiculous.

To what extent do you agree with the above statement?

You should:

- write at least 250 words
- check your grammar, spelling and punctuation

Transcripts

1. Warm up

Interview : 1

Interviewer : How would you describe your management style?

Male: First of all, I demand excellence from myself. With every task I get, I look at how I can exceed expectations. I believe that when you do that, it sets an example to the team and they will follow. It creates a culture of excellence that I want them to benefit from. I'm in the office first thing in the morning and I'm the last to leave. I always give it 110%.

Interviewer: How would your co-workers describe you?

Male: Driven, probably. Second place is the first loser in this game, right? So I'm out to win, to succeed. I'm going to take my team with me all the way to the top.

Interviewer : What would you say are your greatest weaknesses?

Male: That I care too much about my job. If things aren't how I want them, my personal time suffers because I'm working through the weekend to get back on top. Sometimes, that can mean I don't relax the way I should. But I usually find a round of golf helps with that and I'm good to go again.

Interviewer : OK. Can you tell me about a time when there was a conflict with a colleague and how it was resolved?

Male: A couple of years back, there was a lady I worked with that seemed to take a dislike to me for some reason. She was one of these who always left work on time, always had kids to pick up or a dog to feed or whatever. She'd always interrupt me when I was speaking. I just tried to be as polite to her as I could. You're not going to get on brilliantly with 100% of people you meet. She ...uh... moved to another company after a bit, I think.

Interview : 2

Interviewer : What made you apply for this position?

Female: I think it is something that I could do really well. It uses a lot of the skills I already have, but of course I always enjoy challenges so I'd be more than happy to learn more. I'd be grateful of the responsibility and I think it would give me a chance to support my team members in their work which is something I'm always happy to do.

Interviewer : What would you say are your greatest strengths?

Female: I think I'm a good listener. And when I say that, I mean that I can listen to what people are saying and also what they really mean. So I'm good at understanding what people want. I think that is an important part of communication and really, communication is what this is all about. Understanding what people want, what they need, is really what business is all about. You then have to find a way to provide what they want. There's nothing more satisfying than meeting the needs of other people and then you can both come away satisfied.

Interviewer: Tell me about a time when you made a mistake.

Female: Oh, dear. When I first started in management, I had to put together a Profit and Loss sheet. Because I was new to it, I made a bit of a mess of it (laughs). I spent a couple of evenings putting it right, but it gave me a chance to really learn about how to do it properly. I think making mistakes is something you have to allow yourself to do because that's how all of us learn.

Key

1. Warm up

10 mins.

These questions are typical interview questions and the students will benefit from practising them. They are then used in the listening task. Ask the students to discuss them in pairs, or small groups. Circulate and help as needed.

Listening 1

5 mins.

This allows students to hear the interviews before doing the comprehension.

2. Listening comprehension

10 mins.

Ask the students to read the statements before completing the exercise. When they have finished, ask them to discuss the questions. You may want to bring the questions back to the class to get a consensus. The article talks about how overconfident men are often promoted, so if students feel the man is management material, it might be good to circle back to this.

3. Focus on vocabulary

5 mins.

Ensure students can correctly pronounce the target vocabulary. Ask students to complete the task unaided in the first instance, but allow them to use a reference later if needed.

Part A

1. → f. 2. → g. 3. → c. 4. → a. 5. → b. 6. → e. 7. → h. 8. → d.

Part B

10 mins.

Students may well need to use a dictionary to complete this exercise. When they have finished, ask them to discuss the questions in pairs or small groups to practise using the vocabulary.

1. inadvertent	2. intimidation	3. scrutinise	4. assert
5. incompetent	6. intolerant	7. thriving	8. mediocre

4. Skimming for gist

5 mins.

You may want to set a strict time limit to encourage skim-reading rather than reading in detail.

1. f 2. not used 3. b 4. c 5. not used 6. a 7. d 8. e

5. Reading comprehension

5 mins.

Ask students to complete the summary with words which are grammatically correct and taken straight from the article.

1. learning from mistakes	2. Indigenous	3. luxury of
4. overconfidence	5. channelled	6. norms

FEEDBACK



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-S57F-SVFA

1 Warm-up

Discuss these questions in pairs or small groups:

1. What **feedback** has your teacher given you recently?
2. Do you have to give/receive feedback to/from colleagues as part of your job? How do you feel about this?
3. Can you think of any other times (besides work) when you give or receive feedback?
4. When people receive feedback, they sometimes become **defensive** (quick to react negatively when receiving criticism). Can this ever be prevented?

2 Tune in

You are going to watch a TED talk by cognitive psychologist LeeAnn Renninger, called "The Secret to Giving Great Feedback." It's helpful if you first watch the beginning of a presentation, to get used to the speaker's accent and speed of delivery.

Watch the introduction to the presentation (0:00-0:41) and notice what the speaker says about:

Video

1. Two jobs
2. An ancient philosopher
3. The results of a survey

After you listen, explain why these things are mentioned.

3 Listen: How we react to feedback

In this part of the talk (0:41-1:47), you will hear about why some feedback isn't brain-friendly.

Watch to find the answers to these questions:

1. What two types of feedback-givers are there? Why are both of these types of feedback a problem?
2. When people receive feedback, how does the amygdala (a part of the brain) respond?
3. The speaker has done some research to improve how people give feedback. How did she find people for her research?
4. How many parts does the speaker's feedback formula have?

Vocabulary in context - choose the best meaning for the word in bold from the tapescript:

... the feedback giver then starts to ... add more ums and uhs and justifications, and the whole thing **gets wonky** really fast.

a. Turns into an argument
b. Generally goes wrong
c. Becomes very unclear

4 Listen: Feedback formula part 1 and 2

In this part of the talk (1:47-2:27), you will hear about the first part of the formula. Watch to decide if these statements are true or false:

1. The first part of the feedback formula starts with a yes/no question.
2. At this stage, you only have to be short.
3. This stage tricks the brain into feeling happy.
4. People who are receiving feedback can decide how to answer the question.

Vocabulary in context - find words in this part of the tapescript which describe these feelings:

- Support for an idea or plan
- Independence and the ability to make choices

This micro-yes question does two things for you. First of all, it's going to be a pacing tool. It lets the other person know that feedback is about to be given. And the second thing it does is it creates a moment of buy-in. I can say yes or no to that yes or no question. And with that, I get a feeling of autonomy.

In this part of the talk (2:27 - 3:22), you will hear about the second part of the formula. Watch to find the answers to these questions:

1. What is a *blur word*? Give an example.
2. How is a *data point* different to a *blur word*?
3. Does this advice only apply to negative feedback?

Vocabulary in context - can you explain what the expression in bold means?

And if we stick with blur words, they actually **won't have any clue** particularly what to do going forward to keep repeating that behaviour.

5 Listen: Feedback formula part 3 and 4

In this part of the talk (3:22 - 4:49), you will hear about the third and fourth parts of the formula, plus an extra piece of advice. Watch to find the answers to these questions:

1. What information does the impact statement include? Is it always negative?
2. How does the impact statement help make your point?
3. What is the fourth part of the feedback formula?
4. Why is this important?
5. What's the final thing that the speaker says great feedback givers also do?

Vocabulary in context - watch this part again and replace the words in bold with words from the tapescript that have the same meaning. The first letters have been given.

The third part of the feedback formula is the impact statement. Here, you name exactly how that data point **affected/i**_____[1]. you. So, for example, I might say, "Because I didn't get the message, I was blocked on my work and couldn't move forward" or "I really liked how you added those stories, because it helped me **understand/g**_____[2] the concepts faster." It gives you a sense of purpose and meaning and logic between the points, which is something the brain really **wants and needs/c**_____[3].

The fourth part of the feedback formula is a question. Great feedback givers **finish/w**_____[4] their feedback message with a question. They'll ask something like, "Well, how do you see it?" Or "This is what I'm thinking we should do, but what are your thoughts on it?" What it does is it creates a **promise to do something/c**_____[5] rather than just **following the rules/c**_____[6]. It makes the conversation no longer be a monologue, but rather becomes a joint problem-solving situation.

6 Roleplay

Work in pairs. Read the situations and choose one to practise giving feedback to someone you are managing:

- Your colleague was preparing some information that you need to give a presentation tomorrow. You were expecting this information yesterday and you still haven't received it.
- Every day your colleague is a few minutes late in the morning and they leave the office a few minutes early in the evening. They say this is because of the trains.
- Your colleague came to an important meeting with a client, dressed in sportswear. They then took a call on their mobile during the meeting, keeping the client waiting for five minutes.

Follow the formula and advice from the talk and make notes of key words for your feedback. Then deliver your feedback to a partner.

Tips	Key words
1 micro-yes - let the brain know that feedback is coming	
2 data point - avoid blur words	
3 impact statement - be specific	
4 question - make sure you're working together	

After you deliver your feedback, ask your partner if they think you followed the formula well. How did you both feel about using the formula to deliver and receive feedback?

Transcripts

2. Tune in

TUNE IN (0:00 - 0:41)

If you look at a carpenter, they have a toolbox; a dentist, they have their drills. In our era and the type of work most of us are doing, the tool we most need is actually centered around being able to give and receive feedback well.

Humans have been talking about feedback for centuries. In fact, Confucius, way back in 500 BC, talked about how important it is to be able to say difficult messages well.

But to be honest, we're still pretty bad at it. In fact, a recent Gallup survey found that only 26 percent of employees strongly agree that the feedback they get actually improves their work. Those numbers are pretty dismal.

3. Listen: How we react to feedback

HOW WE REACT TO FEEDBACK (0:41 - 1:47)

So what's going on? The way that most people give their feedback actually isn't brain-friendly. People fall into one of two camps. Either they're of the camp that is very indirect and soft and the brain doesn't even recognize that feedback is being given or it's just simply confused, or they fall into the other camp of being too direct, and with that, it tips the other person into the land of being defensive.

There's this part of the brain called the amygdala, and it's scanning at all times to figure out whether the message has a social threat attached to it. With that, we'll move forward to defensiveness, we'll move backwards in retreat, and what happens is the feedback giver then starts to dysregulate as well. They add more ums and uhs and justifications, and the whole thing gets wonky really fast.

It doesn't have to be this way. I and my team have spent many years going into different companies and asking who here is a great feedback giver. Anybody who's named again and again, we actually bring into our labs to see what they're doing differently. And what we find is that there's a four-part formula that you can use to say any difficult message well.

4. Listen: Feedback formula part 1 and 2

FEEDBACK FORMULA PART 1 (1:47 - 2:27)

OK, are you ready for it? Here we go. The first part of the formula is what we call the micro-yes. Great feedback givers begin their feedback by asking a question that is short but important. It lets the brain know that feedback is actually coming. It would be something, for example, like, "Do you have five minutes to talk about how that last conversation went" or "I have some ideas for how we can improve things. Can I share them with you?" This micro-yes question does two things for you. First of all, it's going to be a pacing tool. It lets the other person know that feedback is about to be given. And the second thing it does is it creates a moment of buy-in. I can say yes or no to that yes or no question. And with that, I get a feeling of autonomy.

FEEDBACK FORMULA PART 2 (2:27 - 3:22)

The second part of the feedback formula is going to be giving your data point. Here, you should name specifically what you saw or heard, and cut out any words that aren't objective. There's a concept we call blur words. A blur word is something that can mean different things to different people. Blur words are not specific. So for example, if I say "You shouldn't be so defensive" or "You could be more proactive." What we see great feedback givers doing differently is they'll convert their blur words into actual data points. So for example, instead of saying, "You aren't reliable," we would say, "You said you'd get that email to me by 11, and I still don't have it yet." Specificity is also important when it comes to positive feedback, and the reason for that is that we want to be able to specify exactly what we want the other person to increase or diminish. And if we stick with blur words, they actually won't have any clue particularly what to do going forward to keep repeating that behavior.

5. Listen: Feedback formula part 3 and 4

FEEDBACK FORMULA PART 3 and 4 (3:22-4:49)

The third part of the feedback formula is the impact statement. Here, you name exactly how that data point **impacted** you. So, for example, I might say, "Because I didn't get the message, I was blocked on my work and couldn't move forward" or "I really liked how you added those stories, because it helped me **grasp** the concepts faster." It gives you a sense of purpose and meaning and logic between the points, which is something the brain really **craves.**

The fourth part of the feedback formula is a question. Great feedback givers **wrap** their feedback message with a question. They'll ask something like, "Well, how do you see it?" Or "This is what I'm thinking we should do, but what are your thoughts on it?" What it does is it creates **commitment** rather than just **compliance**. It makes the conversation no longer be a monologue, but rather becomes a joint problem-solving situation.

But there's one last thing. Great feedback givers not only can say messages well, but also, they ask for feedback regularly. In fact, our research on perceived leadership shows that you shouldn't wait for feedback to be given to you – what we call push feedback – but rather, you should actively ask for feedback, what we call pulling feedback. Pulling feedback establishes you as a continual learner and puts the power in your hands. The most challenging situations are actually the ones that call for the most skillful feedback. But it doesn't have to be hard. Now that you know this four-part formula, you can mix and match it to make it work for any difficult conversation.

Key

1. Warm-up

5 mins. Elicit or explain feedback (here meaning an evaluation of someone's performance at work; saying how well they are doing something). Go over the questions and give students a few minutes to discuss these in pairs before checking with the whole class. Defensive is an important word later on in the lesson so check students understand this; for monolingual classes, you could offer a translation. If students do not have much experience of work, it may be better to go over the questions with the whole group at the same time.

ANSWERS: 1 & 2 students' own answers; 3 teachers give feedback to students, and customers give feedback in a shop or restaurant. People also give feedback in any kind of relationship, if informally. 4 students' own answers, but if they think a defensive reaction can be prevented, encourage them to explain how.

2. Tune in

5 mins. The purpose of this stage is to allow students to adjust to the speaker's voice and pacing, while at the same time allowing them to respond to the introduction. Set the task first and then watch the video clip. It's short, so if students need to listen again, they can. Go over the answers with the whole class and encourage students to respond in their own words.

ANSWERS: 1 the two jobs are carpenter and dentist, who both have their own tools so they can work. In the same way, most of us need to use feedback as a tool in our work. 2 The ancient philosopher was Confucius (500 BC), who said that we needed to be able to give feedback effectively. 3 The survey results were that only 26% of employees felt that they received useful feedback that helped them to improve their performance at work.

3. Listen: How we react to feedback

5 mins. Explain the title of this section of the talk and go over the questions. Students then watch the video; it's a short clip so it's best if students simply watch and remember the answers rather than trying to make notes at the same time. After watching, they can discuss the answers in pairs and then check with the whole class, using their own words to give answers. Students could make brief notes at this stage. Then look at the Vocabulary in context question and choose the best answer.

ANSWERS: 1 People sometimes give feedback so indirectly that it is not recognised or understood. Other people are too direct in the feedback and this leads to defensiveness. Either way, no action can be taken to improve. 2 The brain recognises feedback as a social threat which results in defensiveness or retreat. 3 The speaker went into companies and asked who gave the best feedback. She then investigated what these people did that made their feedback so good. 4 There are four parts. Vocabulary in context gets wonky is (b) generally goes wrong. This item is informal, usually spoken.

4. Listen: Feedback formula part 1 and 2

15 mins. This stage and the next one follow a very similar pattern to the previous listening task. Work on each stage separately. For each stage, explain the title of this section of the talk and go over the questions. Students then watch the video; it's a short clip so it's best if students simply watch and remember the answers rather than trying to make notes at the same time. If they need to watch a second time, they can. Students can use the tapescript for support if necessary. After watching, they can discuss the answers in pairs and then check with the whole class, using their own words to give answers. Students could make brief notes at this stage. Then answer the Vocabulary in context question and check pronunciation.

ANSWERS: Part 1 (true or false) - 1 true - it's called a micro-yes; 2 false - it should be both short and important; 3 false - it lets the brain know feedback is coming; 4 true. Vocabulary in context - support for an idea or plan = buy-in; independence and the ability to make choices = autonomy. Part 2 - 1 a blur word is a word that means different things to different people, eg defensive, proactive or reliable. Blur means to make something unclear. 2 A data point is objective information, eg referring to specific events and times. 3 It's important to give specific information for both negative and positive feedback. Vocabulary in context - won't have any clue = won't have any idea/won't know. This item is informal and usually spoken as well, eg I don't have a clue = I don't know.

5. Listen: Feedback formula part 3 and 4

15 mins. Repeat the instructions for the previous activities. For the Vocabulary in context, first go over the instructions and allow students time in pairs to look through the exercise so they can remember or predict the missing words, using the first letters that are given (number 4 is tricky as the first letter is w but the first sound is /r/). Then listen to the clip a second time and check answers and pronunciation.

ANSWERS: 1 The impact statement explains the effect a specific action had on the work. It can be either positive or negative. 2 The impact statement gives a reason and meaning to the points you are making. 3 The fourth part of the feedback formula is a question, inviting the other person to give their point of view. 4 This is important because it turns the feedback process into a cooperative effort. 5 Great feedback givers also actively ask for feedback themselves so they continue to learn all the time.

Vocabulary in context:

1. impacted 2. grasp 3. craves 4. wrap 5. commitment 6. compliance

6. Roleplay

15 mins. In this stage students work in pairs to try out the feedback formula. Go over the three scenarios and ask each pair to choose a different one. Then each student can plan what they want to say using the form. They should just write key words to help them remember what they want to say. Finally, students take turns in their pairs to deliver the feedback for their scenario to their partner. Monitor students and support them to produce natural phrasing and appropriate intonation - it can be difficult for language learners to convey sensitive information in a natural manner. Students can find some natural phrases in the tapescript. After the roleplay, the person receiving the feedback should then comment on how well the formula was followed. At the end of the activity, both students can reflect on how useful they found the formula. Find out from the class how they felt.

GROUPON CULTURE



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-T57F-UP91

1 Warm-up

Have you ever used a discount voucher website such as Groupon to purchase something? Were you satisfied with the experience?

2 Reading

Read about the internet company Groupon on the next page and complete the definitions below with the base forms of words or expressions from the text.

1. _____ (adjective, P1): relatively unknown
2. _____ (verb, P1): to be too excessive for somebody
3. _____ (idiom, P3): to rapidly become popular somewhere
4. _____ (noun, P4): a portion of the profits
5. _____ (noun, P5): somebody who looks for things that can be bought for special low prices
6. _____ (verb, P6): to increase
7. _____ (phrasal verb, P7): to accept (an offer or invitation) from somebody
8. _____ (idiom, P7): to do what somebody else is doing
9. _____ (verb, P8): to collect together
10. _____ (verb, P8): to cause something to happen
11. _____ (noun, P9): a reduction in price

THE INDEPENDENT

Groupon culture in the UK

American online voucher giant Groupon is making moves to attract British bargain hunters.

1. It was a few days after Christmas 2010. At an obscure dry cleaners in London, a large group of trendy young people turned up with their laundry, overwhelming the staff of the Drycentre on Southgate Road.
2. What was it that had caused this sudden demand for dry cleaning services? It was a special offer selling £30 worth of Drycentre services for just £10, an offer advertised to local residents via an email from an internet company called Groupon.
3. In the US, Groupon was already a sensation and it was taking the UK by storm, too. More and more people were signing on to receive its daily diet of special offers from local businesses. In February 2011, it covered 500 cities in 35 countries, boasting 50 million users who had signed up to get emails. Since the company was founded in 2009, they had saved over $1.2bn (£740m) in total. Despite its low-profile, Groupon already boasted five million users in the United Kingdom. According to Forbes magazine, it was the fastest-growing company in the history of the world, in terms of the revenues it is generating. In 2010, Google offered to buy the company for $6bn, but its founders were unimpressed and turned the offer down.
4. Groupon offers a "win-win-win": customers get more than half off on special deals at their local restaurants, shops or other businesses; the local merchants get many more new customers than newspaper advertising could ever generate; and Groupon takes a cut of typically half of whatever money changes hands. Essentially, Groupon has made it trendy to seek out a bargain.
5. **How Britain became a coupon culture**

   Even before the emergence of Groupon in the United Kingdom, younger bargain hunters in Britain were already using websites such as vouchercodes.co.uk to seek out bargains on the high street or on the internet. These sites acted as shop windows for goods or services on offer from providers, who pay the voucher website a fee for each person who downloads their money-saving code.
6. Although supermarket loyalty cards remained the saving scheme of choice for 20 million bargain hunters in the UK, Groupon radically changed the discount marketplace. But before the US giant entered Britain, one pizza firm, Pizza Express, had already boosted its revenues with the inventive use of vouchers.
7. By sending out some forwardable two-for-one vouchers that were downloadable from the firm's website, they attracted 4.5 million customers keen to take them up on the offer. Other restaurants were quick to follow suit.
8. Groupon's model is different. Instead it aggregates offers on its site and chooses a single one to be the coupon of the day. This coupon must then be downloaded by a certain number of users on a particular day to trigger the discount. If not enough people download the voucher, the offer remains inactive.
9. The result of this is that markdowns have become ever larger, as companies can precisely calculate what revenues certain reductions will bring in.

Adapted from The Independent, 16 February 2011

Now read the article again and find the following information:

1. The number of countries and cities covered by Groupon in February 2011: _____ countries, _____ cities
2. The number of Groupon users in February 2011: _____
3. The number of Groupon users in the UK in February 2011: _____
4. The amount of money that Google offered to buy Groupon: $_____
5. The typical commission that Groupon takes on a sale: _____ per cent
6. The most popular type of saving scheme used in the UK before Groupon:

   _____
7. The number of customers reached by Pizza Express' online voucher scheme: _____

3 Checking understanding

What do you remember about Groupon? Answer the questions below.

1. Why did Groupon's founders turn down Google's offer to buy the company?
2. How does Groupon offer a "win-win-win"?
3. How did bargain hunters in the UK seek out bargains on the internet before Groupon?
4. How did Pizza Express' voucher system work?
5. How is Groupon's model different?
6. How does Groupon's model make it possible to offer very large discounts?

4 Talking point

Discuss: Is there a 'Groupon culture' in your country? Are there any other voucher/coupon websites which are popular?

Now read the information below:

Groupon troubles

In November 2011, Groupon went public. In its first earnings release as a public company, Groupon reported a 2011 fourth-quarter loss of $9.8 million, disappointing investors. Despite performing better in 2012, the company failed to meet revenue expectations and its market valuation fell dramatically from $17.8 billion on its first day of trading to just under $3 billion (as of mid-August 2012).

Do you think Groupon offers a "win-win-win"? Below are some of the problems that small businesses have experienced. Discuss how you think they might affect Groupon's business model and consequently the value of the company.

- Many small businesses are unprepared for the sudden rush of new customers.
- Both regular and new customers can get big discounts from the same company via Groupon.
- Groupon customers often get priority treatment over regular customers.
- Staff have to be trained to deal with additional paperwork and verify coupons.
- Restaurant tips from Groupon customers are based on the discounted price of the meal.

Can you think of any reasons why Groupon's stock has fallen?

Key

2. Reading

1. obscure
2. overwhelm
3. take somewhere by storm
4. cut
5. bargain hunter
6. boost
7. take somebody up on something
8. follow suit
9. aggregate
10. trigger
11. markdown

1. 35 countries, 500 cities
2. 50 million
3. 5 million
4. 6bn
5. 50
6. supermarket loyalty cards
7. 4.5 million

3. Checking understanding

1. They were unimpressed.
2. Customers get special prices, local businesses get new customers, Groupon takes a cut.
3. They used voucher websites such as vouchercodes.co.uk
4. They sent out forwardable two-for-one vouchers downloadable from the firm's website.
5. Groupon aggregates offers on its site and chooses one to be the coupon of the day.
6. The coupon must then be downloaded by a certain number of users on a particular day to trigger the discount. If not enough people download the voucher, the offer remains inactive.

4. Talking point

Encourage students to come up with examples of how each problem would have an adverse effect on the small businesses who want to use Groupon to attract new customers. For example, consumers overwhelm restaurants, order very low priced meals, strain waiters and cooks, get poor service, and never return. Regular customers who can get big discounts from Groupon, and who otherwise would have paid the full price, result in the merchant losing money without gaining a new customer. Customer service becomes less efficient and staff training costs rise. All these of problems would have a knock-on effect on customer loyalty and repeat business from consumers and merchants. Groupon's stock could also have fallen due to high business costs.

NEGOTIATING DEALS



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-T57E-H1D3

1 Types of negotiation

Complete the phrases and match them to their correct definition:

1. A win- sum game ⇒ a situation in which a benefit gained by one side means a loss to the other side
2. A zero- win situation ⇒ a situation in which both sides benefit.

2 The negotiation process

Complete the following typical stages of a negotiation:

compromise	concessions	counter	details	interests
procedure	proposals	rapport	stalemate	table

1. Build _____ ⇒ develop an understanding of and ability to communicate with someone
2. Probe _____ ⇒ find out the other side's expectations
3. Begin the bargaining _____ ⇒ start to negotiate the terms of an agreement
4. Make _____ ⇒ make suggestions
5. Make _____ proposals ⇒ react to suggestions
6. Reach a _____ ⇒ arrive at a situation which no progress can be made
7. Make _____ ⇒ allow or give up things in order to reach an agreement
8. Reach a _____ ⇒ arrive at an agreement where both parties reduce their demands in order to agree
9. Work out the _____ ⇒ discuss all the aspects of the deal
10. Return to the negotiating _____ ⇒ re-negotiate an agreement

3 Listening

Listen to the following extracts from a negotiation. Which stages from Exercise 2 did you notice?

Audio 1

Extract 1: _____

Extract 2: _____

Audio 2

4 Negotiation tactics

Match the following common 'manipulative' negotiation tactics to their descriptions. Can you think of any dangers in using them? Which type of negotiation in Exercise 1 do they represent?

1. The negotiation decoy	a. add extra false interests to your agenda which you can bargain with, without affecting your real interests
2. The extreme offer	b. appear as if you are ready to break off the negotiations unless your interests are met
3. Negotiation nibbling	c. ask for more or offer less than expected in order to make 'concessions' later
4. Good cop bad cop	d. make one last 'small' demand once the deal has been done hoping that your opponent will agree in order not to harm the agreement
5. Mention the competition	e. make references to what your opponent's competitors are offering in order to gain the concessions that you want.
6. Negotiation limits	f. one member of your team is demanding and inflexible (the bad cop), the other appears to be pleasant and reasonable (the good cop). Your opponent will have to deal with the good cop.
7. Take it or leave it	g. state limitations (e.g. money, time), real or imagined, hoping that your opponent will make a concession to meet your limit.
8. Negotiation silence	h. stop talking during the negotiation in the hope that your opponent will become uncomfortable and want to make a concession in order to break the silence.

Which negotiation tactic above would you 'neutralise' with the following responses?

a. Probe each interest thoroughly, e.g. by asking how each one helps your opponent.

b. Focus your efforts on Mr./Mrs. Nasty and ignore Mr./Mrs. Nice. Alternatively, just ignore the tactic altogether.

c. Be very clear about what is included and excluded in the deal. Resist the temptation to make this final concession.

d. Show your surprise and allow yourself to laugh. Mention other deals you have made to persuade your opponent to adjust his/her expectations.

e. Ignore the threat and continue the negotiation as if you have not heard it.

f. Restate your offer. Do not make any suggestions or concessions. In extreme cases, get up and walk out the door in the hope that your opponent will call you back and continue in a reasonable manner.

g. Make sure you know what your competitors are offering and be prepared to explain how your product or service differs in terms of value.

h. If you can make this concession, make sure you get something back. Alternatively, focus on how your product or service will save your opponent time or money in the long-term.

5 Useful Expressions

Complete the expressions that you heard in the dialogues:

agree	deal	flexibility	for	halfway	make	manage
mind	prepared	reasonable	room	get	throw	work

Opening the negotiation

1. So, shall we Get down to business, then?

Stating/probing interests

2. We were looking to _____ an order for 100 cases.
3. What sort of price did you have in _____ ?
4. We were hoping _____ a unit price of around €4.50.

Bargaining

5. Would you be willing to meet us _____ ?
6. If you cut your delivery time by, say, 10 days, we would be _____ to pay the price you have proposed.
7. We'd need to see a bit more _____ on terms of payment.

Rejecting a proposal

8. Come on, let's be _____ here.
9. Unfortunately, I don't have any more _____ to negotiate this fee.

Accepting a proposal

10. I suppose we could _____ that.
11. I think we could _____ something out here.
12. I think we could _____ on 3 weeks.
13. Sure, we can _____ that in.

Closing the deal

14. OK, it's a _____ .



6 The grammar of diplomacy

In order to negotiate more effectively, various grammatical features are used to keep your options open, soften 'bad news' and generally make remarks and questions more diplomatic and persuasive. Find examples from the expressions for each of the following features:

1. Continuous forms of tenses: _____
2. Modifiers, e.g. a bit, a little: _____
3. Would/might/could: _____
4. Approximation, e.g. sort of _____
5. Introductory softeners, e.g. 'unfortunately': _____

7 Role play

Work with a partner. Imagine you are negotiating a deal with one of your actual customers. Use language from this lesson. Take turns to be supplier and customer.

Transcripts

3. Listening

multicnt 2@@everypar @parshape =,=.	I notice you have a Russian name.
B:	Yes, my father is from Moscow.
A:	Oh really? Do you speak the language?
B:	I speak intermediate Russian and I can also read. It's quite a challenge to been to Russia?
A:	Not yet, but I'd love to visit St Petersburg.
B:	Oh I recommend you do. St Petersburg is a magnificent city. So, shall we get
A:	Sure. We were looking to make an order for 100 cases.
B:	What sort of price did you have in mind?
A:	We were hoping for unit price of around €4.50.
B:	Ha ha. Come on, let's be reasonable here. We've never gone that low on much higher quantities. For your stated volume, the lowest I could go is Listen, I don't have any more room to negotiate this fee. €7.50 is the botto
A:	OK, well what if we were to...?
multicnt 2@@everypar @parshape =,=.	Would you be willing to meet us halfway? If you cut your delivery time by be prepared to pay the price you have proposed. Most of your competit anyway.
A:	Hmm..I suppose we could manage that. But we'd need to see a bit mor payment.
B:	I think we could work something out there. I'll have to check with head of agree on 3 weeks.
A:	Fine. It's a deal.
B:	Oh, transportation is included, isn't it?
A:	Err, sure. We can throw that in.

Key

1. Types of negotiation

1. A win- ⟶ win situation ⟶ ⇒ a situation in which both sides benefit.
2. A zero- ⟶ sum game ⟶ ⇒ a situation in which a benefit gained by one side means a loss to the other side

2. The negotiation process

1. rapport	2. interests	3. procedure	4. proposals	5. counter
6. stalemate	7. concessions	8. compromise	9. details	10. table

3. Listening

Play the audio files or use your mobile device to scan the QR codes (make sure you have installed a QR code reader app and can access the Internet on your device).

1. Extract 1: 1, 2, 3, 4
2. Extract 2: 4, 5, 7, 8

4. Negotiation tactics

1. a 2. c 3. d 4. f 5. e 6. g 7. b 8. h

a. negotiation decoy
b. good cop, bad cop
c. negotiation nibble
d. extreme offer
e. take it or leave it
f. negotiation silence
g. mention the competition
h. negotiation limits

Extract 1: 1 (neutralised), 8 (neutralised)
Extract 2: 3 (worked)

5. Useful Expressions

2. make	3. mind	4. for	5. halfway	6. prepared	7. flexibility	8. reasonable
9. room	10. manage	11. work	12. agree	13. throw	14. deal	

6. The grammar of diplomacy

1. We were looking, We were hoping
2. a bit more flexibility
3. I think we could..., I suppose we could..., would you be willing..., we would be prepared to...
4. What sort of price..., a price of around...
5. Unfortunately, I don't have any more room...

PROBLEM SOLVING



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-T57D-U21H

1 Problems and solutions

In pairs, study the following sentences and complete the definitions below with the underlined terms.

If you have a problem with your computer, call Mike. He's very good at troubleshooting.

You could try emailing Kate. It's a bit of a long shot, though - she rarely replies.

After a slight hiccup, we managed to launch the product on time.

Taking out a loan to pay for your bills is just a quick fix. You will need to find a more permanent solution.

Lack of employee motivation is a serious obstacle to a company's financial success.

The television screen isn't very clear. I think there must be some sort of defect.

Scientists are studying long-term solutions to the problem of global warming.

1. _____ : a technical problem that prevents something from working properly
2. _____ : a problem which causes a delay but is not very serious
3. _____ : a solution that has little chance of being successful
4. _____ : something that prevents you from making progress
5. _____ : a fast and easy solution that solves a problem only for a short time
6. _____ : discovering and solving problems
7. _____ : solutions which solve a problem for an extended period of time

Can you think of any other examples of quick fixes or long-term solutions? Describe a hiccup or obstacle you've had to deal with in your work.

2 Describing problems

Study the following adjectives:

critical	insignificant	irrelevant	minor	ongoing
persistent	severe	trivial	unimportant	urgent

Which five adjectives describe problems or issues that usually need serious attention?

Now describe the following problems using the adjectives from this exercise:

1. You are stuck in traffic and will be a few minutes late for your English lesson.
2. Your computer suddenly breaks down.
3. You are making breakfast and you discover that you have run out of coffee.
4. One of your colleagues is late for work almost every day.
5. A financial crisis has seriously affected your company's profits.
6. You are in an important business meeting and it starts to rain outside.



3 Problem solving

Listen to two telephone dialogues and answer the questions with '1', '2' or 'both'.

Audio

1. Which dialogue involves a technical problem?
2. In which dialogue was the problem resolved?
3. In which dialogue was the problem considered very urgent?

Now listen again and complete the dialogues on the next page.

Dialogue 1

A: Technical support.

B: Hello Sam, it's Bob here.

A: Hello Bob. What's gone wrong today?

B: Err...yes, well _____[1] sending emails.

A: _____[2]?

B: Well, when I click on the 'Send' button, the emails just remain in the outbox and don't get sent.

A: _____[3] closing and opening the programme?

B: Yes, I have. It didn't help one bit.

A: _____[4] restarting your computer? That might help.

B: I've done that too. No change either. Has something gone wrong with the server again?

A: I don't think so. Everything's working fine for me... Hmm... _____[5] somehow altered the settings on your email programme. Either that or _____[6] your Internet connection.

B: _____[7] the connection. I have no problems accessing the internet.

A: Hmm. _____[8] your settings. _____[9] and try to sort it out.

B: Thanks.

Dialogue 2

A: Hi Daniel, _____[10]. I'm at the conference and I've got my presentation on in 25 minutes but the damn laptop has just crashed on me and I've lost all my PowerPoint slides!

B: Good grief! _____[11] it won't even start up?

A: Yes, exactly.

B: OK, let's not panic. _____[12] made a backup of the data?

A: Yes, I did actually. There should be a CD on my desk.

B: Yes, I can see it from here. Look, _____[13] you get on to the organisers and have them reschedule your presentation. _____[14] my assistant with a replacement laptop.

A: _____[15]. The conference centre seems quite far from our office. How long will it take her to get here?

B: Only about 30 minutes, assuming the traffic doesn't hold her up. So, _____[16] arrange your presentation for 3 o'clock.

A: _____[17]. I'll go and sort it out right away.

Now put the underlined expressions from the dialogues in the following categories:

Declaring a problem: _____

Finding out more details: _____

Diagnosing a problem: _____

Making a suggestion: _____

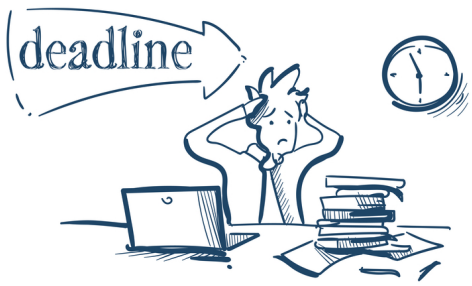
Accepting a suggestion: _____

Rejecting a suggestion: _____

Taking action: _____

Add the following expressions to the above categories:

1. It looks like you have...[+ PAST PARTICPLE]
2. Why don't you try [+ verb -ing]?
3. Yes, that could work.
4. I can see one or two problems with that idea.
5. I'll get on to our suppliers right away.



4 Role play

In pairs, role-play the following situations using the expressions from this lesson. Take turns to be Colleague A and Colleague B.

Problem 1: You can't get hold of the sales director and you need to speak to her immediately because one of your clients has an urgent request.

Colleague A	Colleague B
Declare the problem. Provide details: She's not answering her calls. You've tried emailing her. Accept or reject suggestions. Take action.	You want to know more details: Is she not answering her calls? Has Colleague A tried emailing? Diagnose the problem and make suggestions.

Problem 2: You haven't received any payment from one of your clients.

Colleague A	Colleague B
Declare the problem. Provide details: The payment was due one month ago. You've sent the invoice twice. You've sent an email reminding the client. You haven't called the client about it. This is the first time you've had a problem with this client. Accept or reject suggestions. Take action.	You want to know more details: When was the payment due? Has the client received the invoice? Has Colleague A emailed the client? Has Colleague A called the client? Is this the first time? Diagnose the problem and make suggestions.

Problem 3: One of your best clients is thinking about switching to one of your competitors.

Colleague A	Colleague B
Declare the problem. Provide details: The competitor is offering a cheaper price. You have offered your client a 5 per cent discount. Accept or reject suggestions. Take action.	You want to know more details: Why? Has Colleague A offered the client a discount? How much? Diagnose the problem and make suggestions.

Transcripts

3. Problem solving

Dialogue 1

A: Technical support.

B: Hello Sam, it's Bob here.

A: Hello Bob. What's gone wrong today?

B: Err...yes, well I seem to have a problem sending emails.

A: Can you be a bit more specific?

B: Well, when I click on the 'Send' button, the emails just remain in the outbox and don't get sent.

A: Have you tried closing and opening the programme?

B: Yes, I have. It didn't help one bit.

A: What about restarting your computer? That might help.

B: I've done that too. No change either. Has something gone wrong with the server again?

A: I don't think so. Everything's working fine for me... Hmm... sounds like you may have somehow altered the settings on your email programme. Either that or it could have something to do with your Internet connection.

B: I'm not sure it's the connection. I have no problems accessing the internet.

A: Hmm. In that case it's probably your settings. I'll come over and try to sort it out.

B: Thanks.

Dialogue 2

A: Hi Daniel, it looks like we have a serious problem. I'm at the conference and I've got my presentation on in 25 minutes but the damn laptop has just crashed on me and I've lost all my PowerPoint slides!

B: Good grief! Are you saying it won't even start up?

A: Yes, exactly.

B: OK, let's not panic. I don't suppose you made a backup of the data?

A: Yes, I did actually. There should be a CD on my desk.

B: Yes, I can see it from here. Look, what I suggest is that you get on to the organisers and have them reschedule your presentation. I'll send down my assistant with a replacement laptop.

A: I'm not sure about that idea. The conference centre seems quite far from our office. How long will it take her to get here?

Key

1. Problems and solutions

1. defect
2. hiccup
3. long shot
4. obstacle
5. quick fix
6. troubleshooting
7. long-term solutions

2. Describing problems

Usually needing serious attention: urgent, ongoing, persistent, severe, critical

Answers may depend on the personal experience of the students. Problem 3, for example, would be described as 'irrelevant' by students who don't drink coffee. Possible answers:

1. minor, trivial, persistent, ongoing
2. urgent, severe, critical
3. minor, trivial, unimportant, insignificant, irrelevant
4. ongoing, persistent, severe
5. urgent, severe, critical
6. minor, trivial, irrelevant

3. Problem solving

Play the audio file or use your mobile device to scan the QR code .

1. both
2. 2
3. 2

1. I seem to have a problem
2. Can you be a bit more specific
3. Have you tried
4. What about
5. sounds like you may have
6. it could have something to do with
7. I'm not sure it's
8. In that case it's probably
9. I'll come over
10. it looks like we have a serious problem
11. Are you saying
12. I don't suppose you
13. what I suggest is that
14. I'll send down
15. I'm not sure about that idea
16. the best thing would be to
17. Right, that makes sense

Note: 'Have you tried ....?'/'What about ...?' could be used for making suggestions as well as finding out more details about the problem, depending on the troubleshooter's intentions.

Declaring a problem: I seem to have a problem (1); it looks like we have a serious problem (10)
Finding out more details: Can you be a bit more specific? (2); Are you saying...? (11); Have you tried...? (3); What about...? (4); I don't suppose you...? (12)

Diagnosing a problem: sounds like you may have ... (5); It could have something to do with... (6); I'm not sure it's... (7); In that case it's probably... (8)
Making a suggestion: what I suggest is that...(13); The best thing would be to...(16)
Accepting a suggestion: Right, that makes sense. (17)
Rejecting a suggestion: I'm not sure about that idea. (15)
Taking action: I'll come over (9); I'll send down... (14)

Additional expressions:

1. Declaring a problem
2. Making a suggestion
3. Accepting a suggestion
4. Rejecting a suggestion
5. Taking action

4. Role play

Encourage the use of expressions from the lesson. The problem solving process should follow the scheme of the troubleshooting dialogues, i.e. Colleague A declares the problem without giving any details, Colleague B finds out more details (e.g. 'Are you saying she's not answering her calls?') and diagnoses the problem based on the information provided by Colleague A. Colleague B then makes suggestions. Encourage bad as well as good ideas so that Colleague A has a chance to practise rejecting suggestions before accepting a solution and taking action.

SCALPING



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-R57B-4748

1 Warm up

Read the following situation. In pairs, discuss what you would do.

> **Your favourite music group is going to be performing a concert near your home. You know it's going to be very popular and it will be full.**
>
> **If you buy tickets in advance, it will mean you will have to queue for hours at the ticket office.**
>
> **If you phone, you will have to be ready the minute they go on sale, and you have a busy, full-time job.**
>
> **Alternatively, you could just arrive at the concert on the night and buy them from people outside, but they will cost about 50% more than if you buy them in advance.**

1. Have you ever bought tickets for a concert or a sports event from someone for an increased price? Why?
2. Is this something that happens a lot in your country? Is it legal?

2 Focus on vocabulary

Part A: Underline the correct definition for the following words.

1. scalper (n) - someone who buys a product so that they can **recreate a version of it/ resell it at a higher price/collect large numbers of it**
2. scout (v) - to **look for/create/find** something in a particular place
3. bar (v)- to **encourage someone to do/stop someone from doing/ask someone to stop doing** something
4. retail (n) - the **designing of packaging for customers/selling of products to customers/creation of advertising for customers**
5. scammer (n) - a person who **steals money secretly from people/threatens people with violence for their money/makes money dishonestly by tricking people**
6. entrepreneur (n) - a person who **starts a new type of business/lends people money for their business/buys businesses from people**
7. gaming (n) - the act of **cheating in a card game/hunting and killing birds/playing computer games**
8. commerce (n) - the act of **transporting/buying and selling/investing in** products between people, businesses or countries

Part B: Now put the words from Part A into the correct gap in the following sentences.

1. There's a lot of risk involved in being an _____ , but you can also make an awful lot of money.
2. His parents thought he was wasting his life as all he was interested in was _____ . But now he's making thousands of pounds as a competitor in E-sports competitions.
3. He pretended to be working in the financial industry, but he was actually a _____ and had tricked a lot of people out of their savings.
4. She didn't think she would enjoy working in _____ , but she's now an area manager for a number of shops for a large cosmetics company.
5. The company sent a team over to Germany to _____ for locations for their new office.
6. After the two presidents had met, _____ between the two countries increased considerably.
7. It wasn't cheap, but I managed to buy us all tickets from a _____ outside of the concert.
8. His criminal record will _____ him from owning his own business in this country in the future.

Now answer the following questions.

1. Have you ever been the victim of a **scammer**? What happened?
2. What skills do you think you need to work successfully in **retail**?
3. Do you think **gaming** is a good way to spend your time? Or not? Why?
4. What kind of personality type do you think a successful **entrepreneur** will have? Is it something that appeals to you? Or not? Why?
5. Is **commerce** a subject that you find interesting? Or not? Why?
6. Have you ever been **barred** from doing something you wanted to do? Why? What happened?

3 Rephrasing

Look at the following sentences. Choose the best way (a-c) of rephrasing the section which is underlined.

1. During the advent of the digital age, many companies struggled to adapt.
   a. the early part of
   b. the later part of
   c. the invention of

2. With things like toothpaste and toilet roll, we often buy in bulk as it's a lot cheaper that way.
   a. purchase a smaller size
   b. purchase in a larger shop
   c. purchase in large quantities

3. While many businesses delay paying smaller businesses for their services, I believe there is a moral argument against it.
   a. there is a law preventing it.
   b. it is clearly and ethically wrong.
   c. it is a reasonable idea.

4. When people began streaming films online, the days were numbered for video rental businesses.
   a. there were many days left for
   b. opening times were limited for
   c. time was running out for

4 Skimming for general understanding

Quickly skim through the article and decide which of the following titles match paragraphs 1-4. Two of them are not used.

The need for scalpers

What is scalping?

The future of scalping

Threats of violence

The downside of scalping

Scalping in the pandemic

Scalping

Unfair practice or just business?

1. _____

The original **scalpers** were the people who stood outside music gigs and football matches offering tickets to get inside. On the one hand, they'd mark up those tickets considerably, usually 20% - 40% more than you'd pay from the ticket office, maybe more. On the other, it was quick, convenient, and saved you the trouble of queuing up. With the advent of the Internet and online retail, came bots. Scalpers can use bots (computer software that scans the Internet for specific items) to **scout** the web for tickets far more quickly than a person can. Then, after a 2018 campaign supported by a number of music artists, including *Arctic Monkeys*, *Pixies and Iron Maiden*, the UK government banned the use of these bots. Scalpers were now **barred** from buying tickets in bulk and creating a secondary market.

2. _____

The ban, however, only applied to tickets. Buying up expensive items like gaming consoles and gym equipment and selling them on was still entirely legal. Then in 2020, the Covid-19 pandemic hit and almost overnight, street **retail** closed down, leaving everyone purchasing what they needed, or wanted, online. So, the scalpers set up shop. One of them is Sam, a 17-year-old scalper who is in the process of applying to universities. Instead of spending her time on social media or playing video games, she spends her time buying stock and selling it on. She earns over £2,000 per month. "It's easy money", she says, "it's pocket money". Asked whether she's cheating people out of money, she replies "I'm not a **scammer**, I'm an **entrepreneur** of sorts. The reality is we buy stock, we own it, we can set the price".

3. _____

Others argue there are negative consequences to ordinary people for this type of business. Ryan, 26, found the lockdown during the pandemic difficult and turns to **gaming** as an escape from the pressure. He's been looking out for a PlayStation 5, but the process only increased his levels of stress. "I saw someone posted a picture of 15 stacked up in their hallway selling them for £600 each", (*The PlayStation 5* costs around £400 when bought in a shop) he says. "It's just frustrating". His feelings are shared by Christina, who spent almost two hours in a virtual queue trying to buy the same console for her brother. When she arrived at the front, they were sold out.

4. _____

Complaints from people like Ryan and Christina led to Douglas Chapman, a Scottish politician, seeking to change the law. He wants to ban the use of bots buying large quantities of goods online, just as they are banned with tickets. He sees nothing wrong in people trying to make money but points to a "moral argument" against it, saying people should be able to buy items for the market price. Sam believes Chapman will succeed and that her days of using bots are numbered. However, she believes that scalpers will still buy in large quantities online without using bots. "You're purchasing them in the same way as anyone else, then reselling a product you own," she says. "You can't ban **commerce**".

Source: bbc.co.uk; news.sky.com

5 Comprehension

Read the following statements and decide if they are True, False, or Not Given.

1. Scalpers who sold tickets outside of football matches and music concerts made large amounts of money.
2. These days, British scalpers use special software to quickly find tickets for music concerts.
3. During the 2020 pandemic, scalping expensive items like video games consoles and exercise equipment was not illegal.
4. Like most teenagers, Sam spends a lot of time on social media and gaming.
5. Sam saves most of the money she makes for university.
6. Ryan saw gaming consoles advertised which were marked up by 50%.
7. Douglas Chapman intends to stop people buying large amounts of goods over the Internet.
8. Sam plans to stop scalping once she gets to university.

6 Phrasal verbs

Part A: Underline the correct particle in the following sentences.

1. I can't find flowers for my wife anywhere. It's Valentine's Day tomorrow, and every shop I've been to has sold **up/out/off**.
2. Yes, you need to plan ahead for Valentine's Day. Even if you do find some flowers, they mark **down/off/up** the price several days before. It gets really expensive.
3. The club is going to be packed. People have been queuing **up/around/in** for two hours already, and it's not even opened yet.
4. I'd only had the exercise bike for a couple of months before I sold it **off/on/away** to my brother. I just never had the time.
5. I think they're planning a new housing development here. A local building company has been buying **out/off/up** all the land. They own almost all of it now.
6. I've managed to secure several investors who will help me set **against/up/ down** my new business.
7. Thefts have increased in the stores recently, so we've hired more security guards to look **out/down/up** for shoplifters.
8. We don't seem to be able to sell these new computers, they're all stacked **away/up/against** in the back room still.

Now see if you can find examples of your choices in the text.

Part B: In pairs, discuss the difference in meaning between the following phrasal verbs.

1. *set up* and *set against*
2. *sell up* and *sell out*
3. *buy out* and *buy up*
4. *mark up* and *mark down*
5. *look out* and *look up*
6. *sell on* and *sell off*

7 Talking point

In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. What do you think about the practice of scalping? Is it just business or is it an unfair practice? Explain your answer.
2. What is the difference between a regular business and scalping in your opinion?
3. Do you think that there should be laws against scalping or not? Are there any dangers in banning scalping?
4. Are there any situations where you think scalping would be OK? What are they? Would you buy from a scalper? Why/Why not?

8 Extended activity/homework

Read the prompt and write a paragraph about scalping.

> **Write a paragraph giving your opinion on the practice of scalping. Do you think it should be allowed or not? If not, what should be the punishment for people who do it? If you think it should be allowed, are there any limits to it?**

- Be sure to check your spelling, punctuation and grammar before submitting your work to the teacher.

Key

1. Warm up

5 mins.

Ask students to read the situation and ensure they understand it. You may want to explain to them that this is a practice called "Scalping", which is buying something and selling it for a higher price. Allow them to discuss the situation and the questions and elicit feedback from the class about what they would do and why.

2. Focus on vocabulary

Part A

5 mins.

Ask students to underline the correct options. Then, when they have done this, they can check their work with a dictionary or the Internet if required. Ensure students can pronounce the target vocabulary.

1. resell it at a higher price
2. look for
3. stop someone from doing
4. selling of products to customers
5. makes money dishonestly by tricking people
6. starts a new type of business
7. playing computer games
8. buying and selling

Part B

10 mins.

Ask students to write the correct words from Part A in the gaps. You may want them to identify which part of speech would fit the gap before doing this. When this is complete, ask them to discuss the questions in pairs or small groups.

1. entrepreneur
2. gaming
3. scammer
4. retail
5. scout
6. commerce
7. scalper
8. bar

3. Rephrasing

5 mins.

Ask students to answer the questions. You may want them to discuss their answers in pairs before reviewing the answers as a class. Allow students to use a dictionary or the Internet if needed.

1. a
2. c
3. b
4. c

4. Skimming for general understanding

5 mins.

Ask students to quickly read through the text and decide on the best titles for each of the paragraphs. Set a strict time limit for this to encourage skimming rather than reading in detail. Note that Arctic Monkeys, Pixies and Iron Maiden are British music bands.

1. Not used
2. Paragraph 1
3. Paragraph 4
4. Not used
5. Paragraph 3
6. Paragraph 2

Answers in order:

1. What is scalping?
2. Scalping in the pandemic
3. The downside of scalping

4. The future of scalping

5. Comprehension

10 mins.

Ask students to read in more detail and decide whether the statements are True, False, or Not Given. Ask them to underline where the answer is. If they are unable to do this, it will be Not Given.

1. Not Given. They charged a lot for tickets, but it is not stated whether they made a lot of money from it or not.
2. False. "Then, after a 2018 campaign ... the UK government banned the use of these bots."
3. True. "The ban, however, only applied to tickets."
4. False. "Instead of spending her time on social media or playing video games, she spends her time buying stock and selling it on."
5. Not Given. It is not stated what Sam does with her money, only that she makes 2000 per month.
6. True. "I saw someone posted a picture of 15 stacked up in their hallway selling them for 600 each," (*The PlayStation 5* costs around 400 when bought in a shop)"
7. False. "He wants to ban the use of bots buying large quantities of goods online ..."
8. Not Given. She doesn't think she will be able to use bots for long, but it doesn't say whether she will continue scalping without bots or not.

6. Phrasal verbs

Part A

5 mins.

Ask students to select the correct particle to complete the sentences. Ask them to do it unaided in the first instance and then use a dictionary or the Internet to check their work if required. You may want them to scan through the text to find the phrasal verbs being used.

1. out 2. up 3. up 4. on 5. up 6. up 7. out 8. up

Part B

5 mins.

Ask the students to discuss the differences. You may want to extend the activity by asking them to write sentences using the phrasal verbs from Part A. Ask them to verbally give examples for the different uses of the phrasal verbs. Share good examples with the class. Allow students to use a dictionary or the Internet if needed for this exercise.

1. set up means to start something; set against is to encourage someone to oppose something
2. sell up is when you sell everything, usually because you are moving away; sell out is when you sell all stock of a particular item; it's also to go against your beliefs or principles for money
3. buy out is when you pay someone for their share of a business or a property; buy up is when you buy as much of something as possible
4. mark up is when you increase the price; mark down is when you decrease it, usually to sell it more quickly
5. look out is to watch for something, usually in a dangerous situation; look up is to find information about something, or literally looking upwards with your eyes
6. sell on is when you sell something to someone after you've bought it yourself; sell off is when you sell things for a lower price, usually because you want to get rid of them

7. Talking point

10 mins.

SHARING VIEWPOINTS



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-T578-K29Q

1 Developing a business

Complete the expressions below with the following verbs:

attract expand go (x2) raise

1. _____ capital (= to obtain money for starting or developing a business)
2. _____ a business (= to increase the size of a business)
3. _____ public (= to become a public company listed on the stock exchange)
4. _____ out of business (= to stop operating as a business)
5. _____ shareholders (= to cause people to be interested in buying shares in your company)

2 Management teleconference

Video

You are going to listen to a teleconference in which the managers of an IT distribution company are discussing a business development plan. Answer the questions.

Audio

1. What proposal is being discussed?
2. Is the general opinion for or against?

3 Useful expressions

Now listen again and complete the following expressions.

a. So, where do you all _____ on this?
b. Well, I'm definitely _____ it.
c. Alex, would you like to _____ your views?
d. I have my _____ .
e. He may have a _____ there.
f. Oh, come _____ it!
g. That may _____ be true, but...
h. He's _____ right there.
i. I know this isn't your area, but what's your _____ on this?
j. Well, I haven't _____ it too much thought.

Now put the above expressions in the appropriate category below:

ASKING FOR AN OPINION: _____

SUPPORTING A PROPOSAL: _____

OPPOSING A PROPOSAL: _____

STAYING NEUTRAL: _____

AGREEING WITH AN OPINION: _____

PARTIALLY AGREEING WITH AN OPINION: _____

DISAGREEING WITH AN OPINION: _____

Now study the expressions below and add them to the categories above:

I can't go along with that opinion.
I'm going to sit on the fence on this one.
I couldn't agree more.
I'm in favour of the proposal.
I'm against the plan.
You're right up to a point, but...

Which of the expressions from this exercise are used to strongly agree or disagree with an opinion?

Transcripts

2. Management teleconference

Daniel Goldman: Good morning all. This is Daniel Goldman. As you all know, we are here to discuss the proposal put forward at the last meeting. So, where do you all stand on this?

Anthony Smart: Anthony Smart here. Well, I'm definitely all for it. In the long run, we'll be able to raise the capital that we desperately need to expand the business into new markets.

Daniel Goldman: Alex, would you like to share your views?

Alex Presello: Yes. I have my reservations. My main concern is that by going public and expanding our business, we will lose our competitiveness.

Anthony Smart: What do you mean by that?

Alex Presello: Well, we have a reputation for providing great customer service and treating our clients as individuals. Our customers keep coming back because of the human touch.

Daniel Goldman: He may have a point there. If we end up going for big profits, we'd have to sacrifice customer service and then we'll be competing directly with the multinationals on their terms.

Alex Presello: Not only that, we'd probably lose some of our existing customers. And since the market leaders are better established than we are, it will be tough to compete. We're likely to go out of business.

Anthony Smart: Oh, come off it! There is more to us than just customer service. Don't forget we have negotiated exclusive distribution rights for several of our best-selling products.

Alex Presello: That may well be true Anthony, but the majority of our products are not unique.

Daniel Goldman: He's absolutely right there. Susan, I know this isn't your area, but what's your take on this?

Susan Clarke: Well, I haven't given it too much thought. But I do have one question. Since analysts are likely to have the same concerns as we do, how do we intend to attract potential shareholders?

Key

1. Developing a business

1. raise
2. expand
3. go
4. go
5. attract

2. Management teleconference

Play the audio file or animated video. Alternatively, use your mobile device to scan the QR code (make sure you have installed a QR code reader app and can access the Internet on your device).

1. to become a public company listed on the stock market
2. against

3. Useful expressions

a. stand
b. all for
c. share
d. reservations
e. point
f. off
g. well
h. absolutely
i. take
j. given

ASKING FOR AN OPINION: a, c, i
SUPPORTING A PROPOSAL: b
OPPOSING A PROPOSAL: d
STAYING NEUTRAL: j
AGREEING WITH AN OPINION: e, h
PARTIALLY AGREEING WITH AN OPINION: g
DISAGREEING WITH AN OPINION: f
I can't go along with that opinion. - DISAGREEING WITH AN OPINION
I'm going to sit on the fence on this one - STAYING NEUTRAL
I couldn't agree more. - AGREEING WITH AN OPINION
I'm in favour of the proposal. - SUPPORTING A PROPOSAL
I'm against the plan. - OPPOSING A PROPOSAL
You're right up to a point, but... - PARTIALLY AGREEING WITH AN OPINION
STRONG AGREEMENT: He's absolutely right there; I couldn't agree more; STRONG DISAGREEMENT: Oh, come off it!

SLEEP

LEADERSHIP



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-R57A-EC5H

1 Warm up

In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. How much sleep do you get each night usually? Is it enough? Why/why not?
2. If/When you sleep badly, what is the cause of it usually?
3. Is sleep something you talk about at work?
4. Is being tired or having a nap at work in your country acceptable or not? Why?

2 Listening for gist

Listen to the conversation and decide if the following information is Given (G) or Not Given (NG).

1. Denice drinks coffee. _____
2. Denice's performance at work. _____
3. Denice and Ian live close to the sea. _____
4. Where Denice leaves her phone at night. _____
5. Hours of sleep (a night) Ian gets. _____
6. Ian drinks coffee. _____
7. Ian's plan for the afternoon. _____
8. Denice is feeling exhausted. _____

3 Listening for details

Listen again and complete the notes with one, two or three words.

Denice often doesn't have _____[1] and frequently wakes up _____[2] during the night. Ian suggests that she listens to _____[3], such as the sound of _____[4] or _____[5]. He also recommends not using her _____[6] the night. Other tips he gives are taking _____[7] before bed and trying to make the bedroom as cool as possible, as well as drinking warm milk or _____[8]. He advises her to take _____[9].

Now in pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. Is this a conversation that you can imagine having with your boss if you had been working without sleep? Why/why not?
2. Do you think Ian did the right thing? Why/why not?
3. Have you tried any of Ian's suggestions? Did they work?
4. What advice would you give to someone who wasn't sleeping well?



4 Focus on vocabulary

Part A: Match the vocabulary to the definitions.

1.	all-nighter (n)	a.	a time when you don't go to sleep in order to complete work
2.	mantra (n)	b.	make something less effective or weaker
3.	stamina (n)	c.	purposefully damage something so that it doesn't work effectively
4.	taboo (n)	d.	the power needed, either mental or physical, to complete a task
5.	deprivation (n)	e.	a saying or slogan that is repeated to emphasise its importance
6.	inspiration (n)	f.	the process which is the result of hearing or seeing something uplifting that makes you want to achieve a certain goal
7.	undermine (v)	g.	the state of not having been allowed enough of something
8.	sabotage (v)	h.	a topic that people don't discuss because it's socially unacceptable in some way

Part B: Now put the vocabulary from Part A into the correct gaps in the following sentences. You may have to change the form of the word.

1. Reading about her career was a real _____ to me. She had such a difficult life but managed to help so many people.
2. I have a deadline tomorrow so I think I'm going to have to get some coffee in me and pull an _____ so I can make it.
3. My _____ when it comes to creating presentations is "less is more".
4. I'm absolutely exhausted and don't think I have the _____ to make it through the rest of the day. I may take the afternoon off.
5. When you talk to me like that in front of my team, it really _____ my position as their manager.
6. He kept talking about what a terrible person the president is at dinner without realising that politics is a bit of a _____ subject in business situations.
7. I'm absolutely sure that he deliberately deleted my presentation from my laptop just to _____ my reputation with management. I was so embarrassed. I'm never disorganised.
8. He grew up in a town where there was a lot of social _____ and he's very motivated for his business to create opportunities in that community.

Now in pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. What bad habits do you sometimes have that can **sabotage** your ability to work effectively?
2. What can a manager do that would **undermine** their team's ability to work effectively?

5 Skimming for gist

Quickly read through the article below about sleep leadership and put the verbs in the correct form in gaps (1 – 7).

suffer / expect / think / take / catch / lead / make

Sleeping for the job

Encouraging sleep leadership

A. The concept of working on very few hours' sleep has been around for a while. Lawyers, computer programmers, teachers – perhaps more worryingly, doctors, are among the professions where sleep deficiency is almost like a badge of honour. Long hours during the workday, eating into the evening and weekends are normal, even occasionally doing an all-nighter. We've long been **(1)** _____ up in a culture where less sleep means more work. The trouble is, it's not true. Some leaders are changing the culture and attitudes towards sleep.

B. Jason Fried, the CEO of Basecamp, a US software company leads by example. His mantra is 'eight-eight-eight'. This relates to how the day should be divided: eight hours work, eight hours sleep, and eight hours for life. For a lot of people, work is the main focus and **(2)** _____ up the lion's share of the time in people's days. What is left over is dedicated to sleep and life, and this is often not much. It **(3)** _____ to stress, poor quality of life, and it doesn't result in good work either. 'No one,' says Fried, 'has the stamina or mental capacity to do 14 hours of work.' So, for him, making sure his employees are getting a good night's sleep is in his interest.

C. There are two sides to sleep leadership. One is **(4)** _____sure that management show concern and ask the employees about their sleep. Often, the problem is that discussing sleep, or lack of it, is a taboo topic in the workplace. By changing this and encouraging sleep to be a point of conversation, we can change the way people talk about it and instead of being ashamed for wanting more sleep, they can feel supported. The other side is demonstrating that the sleep employees are getting carries a lot of weight. In Basecamp, workers swap information on getting a good night's rest and care is taken to ensure employees don't feel the need to work in excess of eight hours. Therefore, meetings are limited and brief. Time given to uninterrupted work has the highest priority. Any employee who sends emails late at night receives a gentle reminder that they are not **(5)** _____ to work outside of work hours.

D. When you are **(6)** _____ from sleep deprivation, you are not able to perform at your best. This is true for everyone from the CEO down. You can't think clearly and you're more likely to react badly or emotionally when presented with a problem. No one is fun to be around when they're tired and that includes leaders. A manager who has had a poor night's sleep isn't going to be an inspiration for their team.

E. There's a growing recognition around the importance of health for employees, both in terms of physical and mental well-being. Healthy sleep is a significant part of that because without it, all other areas of life are undermined. Not placing enough importance on the eight hours we spend sleeping can sabotage the other 16 hours we are awake. So stop **(7)** _____ of sleep as a 'nice-to-have' and make it a 'must-have'. You and everyone around you will feel better for it.

Sources: BBC, Base Camp

6 Reading comprehension

Complete the following sentences with one, two, or three words from the article on page four.

1. _____ where not getting enough sleep is common are doctors, lawyers, teachers and computer programmers.
2. Senior managers in some companies are attempting to alter the _____ around how we think about sleep in relation to work.
3. To Jason Fried, it is absolutely in the _____ of all leaders to ensure that their employees are well-rested so that they can perform at an optimal level.
4. One of the issues around the topic is that complaining you're suffering from a _____ sleep is generally not regarded as very professional.
5. If Basecamp employees send emails out of hours, _____ is sent to them underlining that they are not required to be working at that time.
6. From _____ to the newest intern, no one is able to perform at their best when they are sleep deprived.
7. The _____ of employees has been the subject of increased focus lately and this includes the quality of sleep.
8. It's important to treat quality sleep as _____ rather than a bonus.

7 Talking point

In pairs discuss the following questions.

1. Do you agree with the idea that how well people are sleeping should be a subject of discussion in the office? Why/why not?
2. Do you believe that the way Jason Fried manages his employees is something that will happen more and more in working life? Why/why not?
3. What is the attitude towards sleep and work in your country?
4. How well do you function without enough sleep? What could you do to improve the amount of sleep that you get?

8 Extended activity/Homework

Quickly read the article on page four and find words or phrases which mean the same as the following.

1. _____ idea (para. A)
2. _____ not enough of something (para. A)
3. _____ a symbol of a certain quality of status (para. A)
4. _____ the largest proportion of something (para. B)
5. _____ the space or ability to contain something (para. B)
6. _____ given importance (para. C)
7. _____ more than (para. C)
8. _____ the act of acknowledging something is significant (para. E)

Now write a sentence correctly using each of the words you found.

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

Transcripts

2. Listening for gist

Ian: Denice, can you come into my office for a minute?

Denice: Sure. How can I help?

Ian: Oh, there's no problem. I just wanted to have a little chat. You seem really tired.

Denice: Oh, don't worry. Nothing an espresso can't fix. I'm on track for all of my deadlines.

Ian: Absolutely. There's nothing wrong with your work at all. You're not in any trouble. I'm just worried about you. Are you getting enough sleep?

Denice: It's not been great, to be honest. My husband has just started working nights recently. So, I'm alone in the house with the kids and I don't sleep as well when he's not there. There's no real problem, but it's like I hear every single little noise in the house at night. I wake up several times a night. And I often can't get back to sleep.

Ian: I've done that. You lie awake worrying about how you're awake, right?

Denice: Yes! Counting the hours until you absolutely have to get up and wondering if it will be enough for you to get through the day.

Ian: It's the worst. If little noises are waking you up, have you tried listening to white noise at night to drown out the little sounds?

Denice: White noise?

Ian: Yes, like the sound of the ocean or rainfall. The sound of an electric fan even? It's just gentle noise and I find it really helps. It covers all those little noises that might wake you up if it's silent, but your brain doesn't register it as something to focus on.

Denice: I might try that, it's an interesting idea.

Ian: What about your phone? Where is that when you're in bed?

Denice: If I'm being honest, often in my hand. I sometimes check emails and texts if I wake up in the night.

Ian: That doesn't help the situation. It gets your brain working which stops you from sleeping. Also, the light from your phone will make your brain think it needs to be awake. If you can, it's best to leave it in another room.

Denice: I know it's not good for me. But with my husband not around, it makes me feel safer to have it close by.

Ian: I completely understand that. Maybe just putting it on a table across the room would help? Just so it's out of reach but still there if you need it. It'll be less tempting to pick it up and look at it if you wake up.

Denice: Yes, I could do that. I really should try. I'm terrible with my phone.

Ian: You could also try having a warm bath before bed. I find that helps. I also try and keep the room as cool as possible as I sleep better that way. Having a warm drink of herbal tea or milk. I find that helps a lot too.

Denice: Oh, that's an idea. I've got ginger tea which I like, but I hardly ever drink it because I usually need caffeine (laughs).

Ian: Well, give that a go at night. And Denice, I tell you what: who is at home now?

Denice: No one. Why?

Ian: Why don't you take the rest of the afternoon off and catch up on your sleep? Your work will be fine, but it won't stay that way if you're exhausted. I need you at your best and that means sleeping.

Denice: Are you sure?

Ian: I'm absolutely sure. Go and have a nap before your children are home from school. Get some better sleep tonight and come back refreshed tomorrow.

Denice: Thanks so much. I really do feel like I need it.

Ian: It's my pleasure. Let me know how it goes and if there's anything else you need.

Key

1. Warm up

5 mins.

This gently introduces the subject to the class and gets students to think about it from a personal perspective.

2. Listening for gist

5 mins.

This gives students an opportunity to listen to the conversation ahead of the main comprehension task.

1. Given. 'Nothing an espresso can't fix.'
2. Given. 'There's nothing wrong with your work at all.'
3. Not Given. The sound of the ocean is mentioned as something which helps sleep, but it does not say if they live near the sea.
4. Given. 'If I'm being honest, often in my hand.'
5. Not Given
6. Not Given
7. Not Given
8. Given. 'I really do feel like I need it.'

3. Listening for details

10 mins.

Ask students to complete the notes with guesses/predictions and then listen again to check their answers. Once they have completed that, ask them to briefly discuss the questions in pairs or small groups. Circulate and help as needed.

1. enough sleep
2. several times
3. white noise
4. rainfall/the ocean
5. the ocean/rainfall
6. phone during
7. a warm bath
8. herbal tea
9. the afternoon off

4. Focus on vocabulary

Part A

5 mins.

Ensure students can correctly pronounce the target vocabulary. Ask them to complete the task unaided in the first instance, but use a reference to check their work later if needed.

1. → a. 2. → e. 3. → d. 4. → h. 5. → g. 6. → f. 7. → b. 8. → c.

Part B

10 mins.

Ask students to decide which part of speech can fill the gaps before completing the exercise. When they have finished, ask them to discuss the questions in pairs or small groups to practise using the vocabulary.

1. inspiration
2. all-nighter
3. mantra
4. stamina

5. undermines 6. taboo 7. sabotage 8. deprivation

5. Skimming for gist

5 mins.

Ask students to skim read and put the verbs in the correct form in the correct gaps. You may want to set a strict time limit to encourage them to skim read.

Gaps

1) caught, 2) takes, 3) leads, 4) making, 5) expected, 6) suffering, 7) thinking

Sources:

https://www.bbc.com/worklife/article/20220114-can-sleep-leadership-help-banish-burnout

https://basecamp.com/

6. Reading comprehension

10 mins.

Ask students to complete the gaps with one, two or three words from the text. They should make sure their choice is grammatically correct.

1. Among the professions
2. culture and attitudes
3. interest
4. lack of
5. a gentle reminder
6. the CEO
7. well-being
8. a 'must-have'

7. Talking point

10 mins.

Ask students to discuss the questions in pairs or small groups. Circulate and help as needed.

8. Extended activity/Homework

15 mins.

Ask the students to scan to find the target vocabulary. You may want them to make sentences in written form or do the exercise verbally.

1. concept
2. deficiency
3. badge
4. the lion's share
5. capacity
6. carries (a lot of) weight
7. in excess of
8. recognition

SMALL TALK



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-T57B-E64B

1 Warm-up

What typical topics of conversation do people in your country talk about with strangers to be polite?

2 Social exchanges

Match the expressions on the left with the definitions on the right:

1. make small talk	a. to have a conversation about unimportant things with someone you don't know very well
2. talk shop	b. to start to talk with someone you don't know
3. have a chat	c. to talk about business with people you work with when you are not at work
4. exchange a few words	d. to talk to someone in a friendly, informal way
5. strike up a conversation	e. to talk with someone for a very short time

In pairs, describe when you last engaged in the activities above, e.g. *I exchanged a few words with our sales director after the meeting last Monday.*

3 Making conversation

Match the following conversation openers with the responses on the right:

1. Haven't we met somewhere before?	a. I've found it very practical so far. I can't wait to implement some of the ideas that have been discussed.
2. Mind if I join you?	b. Not at all. Be my guest.
3. How do you like our new location?	c. That's right. It's good to see you again. You haven't changed a bit.
4. How are you enjoying the conference?	d. Well, it's certainly a nice change. I see you have a splendid view of the cathedral from your conference room.
5. What are you having?	e. Whatever you're having is fine.
6. Daniel, long time no see. It must be 6 years or so.	f. Yes, I think so. I can't quite remember where though.
7. Do you two know each other?	g. Yes, we're old colleagues. We go back about seven years.

Audio



Match the openers and responses to the situations below. Listen to check you answers.

a. introducing yourself to someone you think you have met before
b. greeting someone you already know
c. asking if you can sit with someone
d. making small talk (x3)
e. offering someone a drink at a bar or restaurant

Now listen again and complete the rest of the mini dialogues:

Dialogue 1

A: A_____ , my name's Helen Rice, from Global Training Solutions.

B: Oh r_____ , it was probably at the management skills development conference in London last year. How do you do. I'm Susan Clarke.

Dialogue 2

A: Wonderful canteen you have here.

B: Yes, we do. I s_____ you've ordered the mushroom soup. G_____ c_____ !

Dialogue 3

A: Yes, it c_____ b_____ all those grey apartment blocks that surrounded our previous headquarters. W_____ are you located?

Dialogue 4

A: Yes, we've c_____ had our f_____ share of marketing experts today. T_____ of marketing, how's your new campaign c_____ along?

Dialogue 5

A: Right. Two beers i_____ is t_____ .

Dialogue 6

A: Neither h_____ you. I'm t_____ that you are now the regional manager.

B: Yes, that's right. It's quite a challenge, you know.

A: I bet!

Dialogue 7

C: Actually it's m_____ l_____ eight. We first started working together during the company merger.

4 Making small talk

Complete the table below with words and expressions from the dialogue extracts on Page 3:

Asking questions: Whereabouts are you located?

Changing the topic: anyway

Using background knowledge: I'm told that

Which categories do the following expressions belong to?

By the way,
I understand that
What are your plans for the summer break?
I hear that
When was the last time you visited this city?

5 Role play

Imagine you are at a conference. Go around the class greeting and making small talk with other people using language from this lesson.

Transcripts

3. Making conversation

Dialogue 1

A: Haven't we met somewhere before?

B: Yes, I think so. I can't quite remember where though.

A: Anyway, my name's Helen Rice, from Global Training Solutions.

B: Oh right, it was probably at the management skills development conference in London last year. How do you do. I'm Susan Clarke.

Dialogue 2

A: Mind if I join you?

B: Not at all. Be my guest.

A: Wonderful canteen you have here.

B: Yes, we do. I see you've ordered the mushroom soup. Good choice!

Dialogue 3

A: How do you like our new location?

B: Well, it's certainly a nice change. I see you have a splendid view of the cathedral from your conference room.

A: Yes, it certainly beats all those grey apartment blocks that surrounded our previous headquarters. Whereabouts are you located?

Dialogue 4

A: How are you enjoying the conference?

B: I've found it very practical so far. I can't wait to implement some of the ideas that have been discussed.

A: Yes, we've certainly had our fair share of marketing experts today. Talking of marketing, how's your new campaign coming along?

Dialogue 5

A: What are you having?

B: Whatever you're having is fine.

A: Right. Two beers it is then.

Key

2. Social exchanges

1. a 2. c 3. d 4. e 5. b

3. Making conversation

Conversation openers - responses:

1. f 2. b 3. d 4. a 5. e 6. c 7. g

Play the audio file or use your mobile device to scan the QR code (make sure you have installed a QR code reader app and can access the Internet on your device).

Openers/responses - situations:

a. 1 b. 6 c. 2 d. 3,4,7 e. 5

Dialogue 1: anyway, right

Dialogue 2: see, good choice

Dialogue 3: certainly beats, whereabouts

Dialogue 4: certainly, fair, talking, coming

Dialogue 5: it, then

Dialogue 6: have, told

Dialogue 7: more like

4. Making small talk

Asking questions: How's your new campaign coming along? What are your plans for the summer break? When was the last time you visited this city?
Changing the topic: talking of, by the way
Using background knowledge: I hear that, I understand that

STARTUP SUCCESS



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-S579-DUXD

1 Warm-up

What is a startup? Can you think of any examples of successful startups?

2 Key words

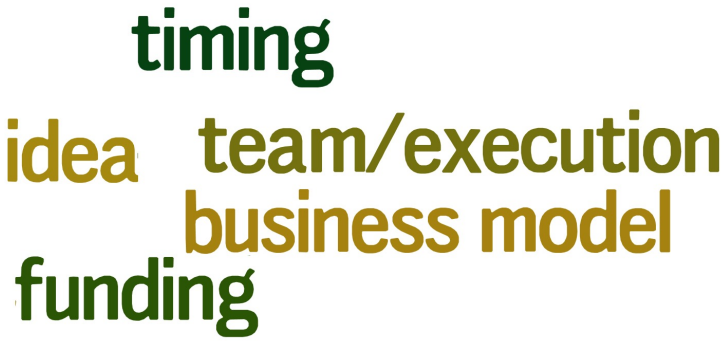
What do you think the underlined words mean? In pairs, match them to their correct definitions below:

1. The salesman provided his potential customer with an incentive to buy the product.
2. We had some misperceptions about the market and that's why the new product failed.
3. When observing the behaviour of music lovers, we suddenly had an "aha" moment and then developed a brilliant idea for a website.
4. They have high hopes for their new website, but I don't think it will become popular.
5. We are looking for a definitive answer to the problem.
6. After we were featured in the newspaper, our idea started to gain traction.
7. I thought their idea was great, but it was passed on by many investors.

a. a sudden insight or discovery
b. expect success
c. fixed, complete or very reliable
d. get more support and interest in order to be successful
e. incorrect understanding of something
f. not considered
g. something that encourages and motivates you to do something

3 Watching and listening

You are going to watch a talk by Bill Gross, founder of Idealab. He is going to talk about what factors make a startup successful. In pairs, discuss the factors below and put them in order from 1 (most important) to 5 (least important). Then watch the talk to compare or correct your answers.



4 Phrasal verbs in the video

Look at the transcript of the talk. There are 6 underlined phrasal verbs. Find a phrasal verb which means ...

1. produce something (especially an idea) _____
2. become successful _____
3. make progress _____
4. begin as one thing and develop into something else _____
5. to allow a house or room that you own to be used by someone who pays you regularly for using it _____
6. be the main factor in something _____

For each phrasal verb, make your own sentence.

5 Talking point

Discuss any of the questions below.

1. Do you agree with the speaker?
2. Which factors were important in the recent success (or lack of it) in your company?
3. Can you think of any other successful startups? Why do you think they were successful?

Transcripts

3. Watching and listening

0:11 I'm really excited to share with you some findings that really surprise me about what makes companies succeed the most, what factors actually matter the most for startup success.

0:24 I believe that the startup organization is one of the greatest forms to make the world a better place. If you take a group of people with the right equity incentives and organize them in a startup, you can unlock human potential in a way never before possible. You get them to achieve unbelievable things.

0:42 But if the startup organization is so great, why do so many fail? That's what I wanted to find out. I wanted to find out what actually matters most for startup success.

0:51 And I wanted to try to be systematic about it, avoid some of my instincts and maybe misperceptions I have from so many companies I've seen over the years.

0:59 I wanted to know this because I've been starting businesses since I was 12 years old when I sold candy at the bus stop in junior high school, to high school, when I made solar energy devices, to college, when I made loudspeakers. And when I graduated from college, I started software companies. And 20 years ago, I started Idealab, and in the last 20 years, we started more than 100 companies, many successes, and many big failures. We learned a lot from those failures.

1:22 So I tried to look across what factors accounted the most for company success and failure. So I looked at these five. First, the idea. I used to think that the idea was everything. I named my company Idealab for how much I worship the "aha!" moment when you first come up with the idea. But then over time, I came to think that maybe the team, the execution, adaptability, that mattered even more than the idea.

1:45 I never thought I'd be quoting boxer Mike Tyson on the TED stage, but he once said, "Everybody has a plan, until they get punched in the face." (Laughter) And I think that's so true about business as well. So much about a team's execution is its ability to adapt to getting punched in the face by the customer. The customer is the true reality. And that's why I came to think that the team maybe was the most important thing.

2:11 Then I started looking at the business model. Does the company have a very clear path generating customer revenues? That started rising to the top in my thinking about maybe what mattered most for success.

2:20 Then I looked at the funding. Sometimes companies received intense amounts of funding. Maybe that's the most important thing?

2:26 And then of course, the timing. Is the idea way too early and the world's not ready for it? Is it early, as in, you're in advance and you have to educate the world? Is it just right? Or is it too late, and there's already too many competitors?

2:38 So I tried to look very carefully at these five factors across many companies. And I looked across all 100 Idealab companies, and 100 non-Idealab companies to try and come up with something scientific about it.

2:48 So first, on these Idealab companies, the top five companies – Citysearch, CarsDirect, GoTo, NetZero, Tickets.com – those all became billion-dollar successes. And the five companies on the bottom – Z.com, Insider Pages, MyLife, Desktop Factory, Peoplelink – we all had high hopes for, but didn't succeed.

3:05 So I tried to rank across all of those attributes how I felt those companies scored on each of those dimensions. And then for non-Idealab companies, I looked at wild successes, like Airbnb and Instagram and Uber and Youtube and LinkedIn.

3:19 And some failures: Webvan, Kozmo, Pets.com Flooz and Friendster. The bottom companies had intense funding, they even had business models in some cases, but they didn't succeed. I tried to look at what factors actually accounted the most for success and failure across all of these companies, and the results really surprised me.

3:36 The number one thing was timing. Timing accounted for 42 percent of the difference between success and failure. Team and execution came in second, and the idea, the differentiability of the idea, the uniqueness of the idea, that actually came in third.

3:50 Now, this isn't absolutely definitive, it's not to say that the idea isn't important, but it very much surprised me that the idea wasn't the most important thing. Sometimes it mattered more when it was actually timed.

4:01 The last two, business model and funding, made sense to me actually. I think business model makes sense to be that low because you can start out without a business model and add one later if your customers are demanding what you're creating. And funding, I think as well, if you're underfunded at first but you're gaining traction, especially in today's age, it's very, very easy to get intense funding.

4:20 So now let me give you some specific examples about each of these. So take a wild success like Airbnb that everybody knows about. Well, that company was famously passed on by many smart investors because people thought, "No one's going to rent out a space in their home to a stranger." Of course, people proved that wrong. But one of the reasons it succeeded, aside from a good business model, a good idea, great execution, is the timing.

4:41 That company came out right during the height of the recession when people really needed extra money, and that maybe helped people overcome their objection to renting out their own home to a stranger.

4:50 Same thing with Uber. Uber came out, incredible company, incredible business model, great execution, too. But the timing was so perfect for their need to get drivers into the system. Drivers were looking for extra money; it was very, very important.

5:02 Some of our early successes, Citysearch, came out when people needed web pages. GoTo.com, which we announced actually at TED in 1998, was when companies were looking for cost-effective ways to get traffic. We thought the idea was so great, but actually, the timing was probably maybe more important. And then some of our failures. We started a company called Z.com, it was an online entertainment company. We were so excited about it – we raised enough money, we had a great business model, we even signed incredibly great Hollywood talent to join the company. But broadband penetration was too low in 1999-2000. It was too hard to watch video content online, you had to put codecs in your browser and do all this stuff, and the company eventually went out of business in 2003.

5:38 Just two years later, when the codec problem was solved by Adobe Flash and when broadband penetration crossed 50 percent in America, YouTube was perfectly timed. Great idea, but unbelievable timing. In fact, YouTube didn't even have a business model when it first started. It wasn't even certain that that would work out. But that was beautifully, beautifully timed.

5:58 So what I would say, in summary, is execution definitely matters a lot. The idea matters a lot. But timing might matter even more. And the best way to really assess timing is to really look at whether consumers are really ready for what you have to offer them. And to be really, really honest about it, not be in denial about any results that you see, because if you have something you love, you want to push it forward, but you have to be very, very honest about that factor on timing.

6:22 As I said earlier, I think startups can change the world and make the world a better place. I hope some of these insights can maybe help you have a slightly higher success ratio, and thus make something great come to the world that wouldn't have happened otherwise.

6:34 Thank you very much, you've been a great audience.

1 Companies are losing control. What happens on Wall Street no longer stays on Wall Street. What happens in Vegas ends up on YouTube. (Laughter) Reputations are volatile. Loyalties are fickle. Management teams seem increasingly disconnected from their staff. (Laughter) A recent survey said that 27 percent of bosses believe their employees are inspired by their firm. However, in the same survey, only four percent of employees agreed. Companies are losing control of their customers and their employees. But are they really?

Key

1. Warm-up

A startup is a business that has recently begun operation, usually associated with innovation. Examples of successful startups include Uber, Airbnb, etc.

2. Key words

1. g
2. e
3. a
4. b
5. c
6. d
7. f

3. Watching and listening

Play the video. According to the speaker, the most important factors are: 1) timing, 2) team/execution, 3) idea, 4) business model, 5) funding.

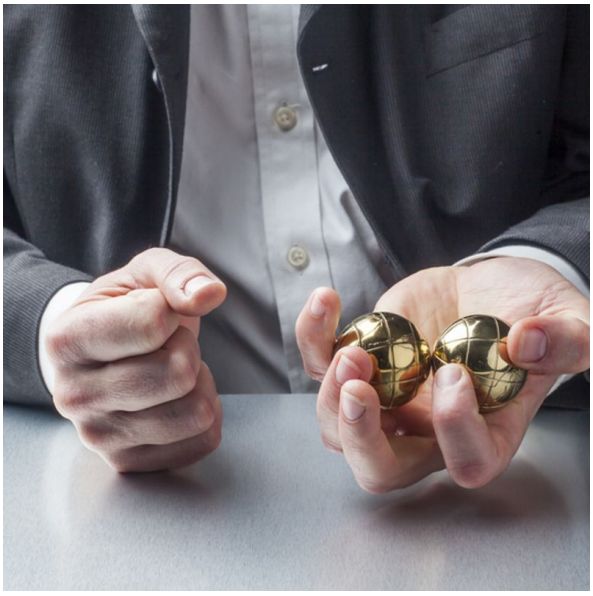
Note: The talk was given a TED (Technology Entertainment Design) conference. TED, founded in 1984, is a global set of conferences owned by a private non-profit foundation, formed to disseminate "ideas worth spreading."

4. Phrasal verbs in the video

Hand out a copy of the transcript to each student. Students can work in pairs.

1. come up with
2. work out
3. push forward
4. start out
5. rent out
6. account for

STRESS RELIEF



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
18L9-T57A-JB33

1 Warm-up

Look at the picture below. What causes people stress at work?



2 Key words

Match the following verbs to their correct definition:

1.	smash something	a.	to break something noisily into small pieces
2.	swing something	b.	to completely destroy something, usually a building
3.	demolish something	c.	to hold something very tightly in a particular place
4.	flinch	d.	to look quickly at something
5.	clamp something somewhere	e.	to make a room or building look new again
6.	glance at something	f.	to make a sound as if something is being broken because it is being pressed very hard
7.	refurbish something	g.	to move away from something suddenly because of fear or surprise
8.	crunch	h.	to move something with your arm from one side to the other

3 Find the information

Now read about an unusual method of relieving stress involving volunteers from Madrid, Spain. Find out the following information.

1. Who has problems on the road?
2. Who was late for work that day?
3. Who deals with bad behaviour at work?
4. Who complained of lack of sleep?
5. Who has a sympathetic wife?

THE INDEPENDENT

Spaniards find smashing new way to relieve stress

Adapted from The Independent, 04 July 2007, by Elizabeth Nash

1. With a Tarzan-like scream, Pablo Varela swung his jackhammer into the wall of a neat hotel bedroom. A mountain of plaster fell to the floor to join a sea of broken mirror-glass crunching under his boots.
2. "I'm exhausted, but very relaxed. I've never done anything like this before. I recommend it to anyone," he said, before laying into a marble bathroom. Mr Varela, 30, a teacher "with difficult pupils", was among 40 volunteers who joined in the light-hearted destruction at a Madrid hotel yesterday, organised by a hotel chain wanting to refurbish an old building - and relieve stress.
3. "We put together our need to demolish our rooms with a government report that Madrilenos suffer high stress levels, and invented the idea of 'roomolition'. We advertised for volunteers and received 1,000 applicants," said Enrique Tellecha, a manager of NH Hotels.
4. He flinched as an exploding television sent people backing out of a room. "I'm surprised how enthusiastic people have been," he said. "It just shows how stressed they are."
5. Sixty applicants chosen by psychologists crowded into the lobby for a special test to produce 40 finalists considered stressed enough to destroy a room. The first test was to hit a life-size puppet of a boss, with a cigar clamped in its jaws, and shout out the thing that most stressed them.
6. There was bitter laughter when Felix Gonzalez, a taxi driver, accompanied his punch with a cry of "M30!" - Madrid's ring road.
7. "Contestants" then had their pulse, blood pressure and heartbeat measured by a nurse, before answering a questions on what was most stressful in their life.
8. Waiting to be tested, Angel Gutierrez, 33, spoke calmly enough, but his knee couldn't stop shaking as he described his job as a strategic consultant for major banks. "I take two or three planes a week. I try to make time for my 15-month-old son, and I do competitive swimming and train late in the evening. I'm always running to the next thing and arriving late."
9. Was this a satisfying life? "Oh yes. We live in an accelerated city, everything's at speed. My wife understands. But when we have another child I'll have to cut down the flights."
10. Sergio Quintana, 31, glanced repeatedly at his two phones and his motorcycle keys. "I work all hours, at a discotheque at night and as events manager and site location manager for big shops in the day. I sleep five hours a night."
11. So why does he keep it up? "To pay the mortgage, travel and live well. But it'll be nice to enjoy a moment of liberation."
12. Carlos Garcia, 32, was breathless and covered in dust. He peeled off his white overalls and checked his watch. "I work in a savings bank and I should be there now," he said. "Must rush."

4 Find the words

Find a word or phrase in the article which means...

1. A powerful, hand-held tool for drilling into hard surfaces (US English) **(noun, P1)** _____
2. a hard substance used to shape walls and ceilings **(noun, P1)** _____
3. not serious **(adj., P2)** _____
4. a toy that has the shape of a person or animal **(noun, P5)** _____
5. special trousers that are worn over regular clothes to protect them **(plural noun, P12)** _____

5 Phrasal verbs

Put the infinitive forms of the underlined phrasal verbs in the article next to their correct definition:

1. attack (someone or something) physically _____
2. remove (clothing) _____
3. maintain the same level of something _____
4. join the parts of something to each other _____
5. become involved in an activity with other people _____
6. do less of something _____
7. move backwards away from something _____
8. fill a place completely (about people) _____

6 Grammar - Reduced relative clauses

Look at the following examples from the text:
...a hotel chain wanting to refurbish an old building...
Sixty applicants chosen by psychologists crowded into the lobby...

The underlined clauses are called **reduced relative clauses**. They begin with the **past participle** ('chosen') or **-ing form** ('wanting').
These clauses can be used instead of relative clauses to give information about what something/someone does (**-ing clauses**), e.g. 'a hotel chain wanting to refurbish an old building' (= 'a hotel chain that wanted to refurbish an old building') or about what is done to something/someone (**past participle clauses**), e.g. 'Sixty applicants chosen by psychologists' (= 'Sixty applicants who were chosen by psychologists').

Find another example of each type of reduced relative clause from the text.

7 Grammar practice 1

Complete the sentences using the following verbs in the '-ing' or '-ed' form:

belong convict cover develop feature invite shout ~~call~~ wait work

1. Someone called Dalia Jones rang while you were at the meeting.
2. Out of 50 people _____ to the party, only 25 showed up.
3. Did you see that strange man _____ aggressively in the street?
4. There were five candidates _____ to be interviewed for the assistant manager position.
5. Rescue workers found a suitcase _____ to one of the victims of the plane crash.
6. The musician released an album _____ all his greatest hits.
7. The new product, _____ by the company's R&D department after 10 years of research, began to dominate the market.
8. The directors decided to hold a board meeting _____ a variety of important issues.
9. At 8 o'clock in the evening, the office was completely empty apart from Jack _____ hard to meet a deadline.
10. The accountant _____ of fraud was sent to prison for five years.

8 Grammar practice 2

Make one sentence from two using either an '-ing clause' or an '-ed clause' to give information about the words in bold.

Example: The sales representative had an **interesting surname**. It began with 'D'.
The sales representative had an interesting surname beginning with 'D'.

1. I bought a new pair of **shoes**. They were made in Italy.
2. She wants to book a **room**. It must overlook the sea.
3. The **new marketing strategy** was discussed at yesterday's meeting. Can you tell me about it?
4. The **building** was destroyed by the fire. Did they rebuild it?
5. Go straight ahead and you will arrive at a **small road**. The road leads to his house.
6. You might receive **certain emails** that claim to be from your bank. Beware of them.
7. Samuel works for a **multinational corporation**. It was established over 50 years ago.
8. We are a **diversified consultancy agency**. We employ over 200 dedicated professionals.
9. A **new film** is going to be released in the cinema next week. It's called 'Sunny Days'
10. On my street there's a **wonderful new restaurant**. It serves Italian food.

9 Talking point

What do you think of the method of stress relief described in the article? What other methods are effective? How do you deal with stress in your work?

Key

1. Warm-up

Brainstorm ideas, e.g. unrealistic deadlines, dealing with difficult customers, heavy workloads, etc.

2. Key words

Physically demonstrate some of the definitions where necessary.

1. a 2. h 3. b 4. g 5. c 6. d 7. e 8. f

3. Find the information

1. Felix Gonzalez 2. Carlos Garcia 3. Pablo Varela 4. Sergio Quintana 5. Angel Gutierrez

4. Find the words

1. jackhammer 2. plaster 3. light-hearted 4. puppet 5. overalls

5. Phrasal verbs

1. lay into 2. peel off 3. keep up 4. put together
5. join in 6. cut down 7. back out 8. crowd into

6. Grammar - Reduced relative clauses

Point out that in '-ing clauses', verbs which are not normally used in the continuous form can be used in the -ing form (e.g. wanting).

-ing clause:...a sea of broken mirror-glass crunching beneath his boots
past participle clause: 40 finalists considered stressed enough to destroy a room..

7. Grammar practice 1

1. - 2. invited 3. shouting 4. waiting 5. belonging
6. featuring 7. developed 8. covering 9. working 10. convicted

8. Grammar practice 2

1. I bought a new pair of shoes made in Italy.
2. She wants to book a room overlooking the sea.
3. Can you tell me about the new marketing strategy discussed at yesterday's meeting?
4. Did they rebuild that building destroyed by the fire?
5. Go straight ahead and you will arrive at a small road leading to his house.
6. Beware of certain emails you might receive claiming to be from your bank.
7. Samuel works for a multinational corporation established over 50 years ago.
8. We are a diversified consultancy agency employing over 200 dedicated professionals.
9. A new film called 'Sunny Days' is going to be released in the cinema next week.
10. On my street there's a wonderful new restaurant serving Italian food.